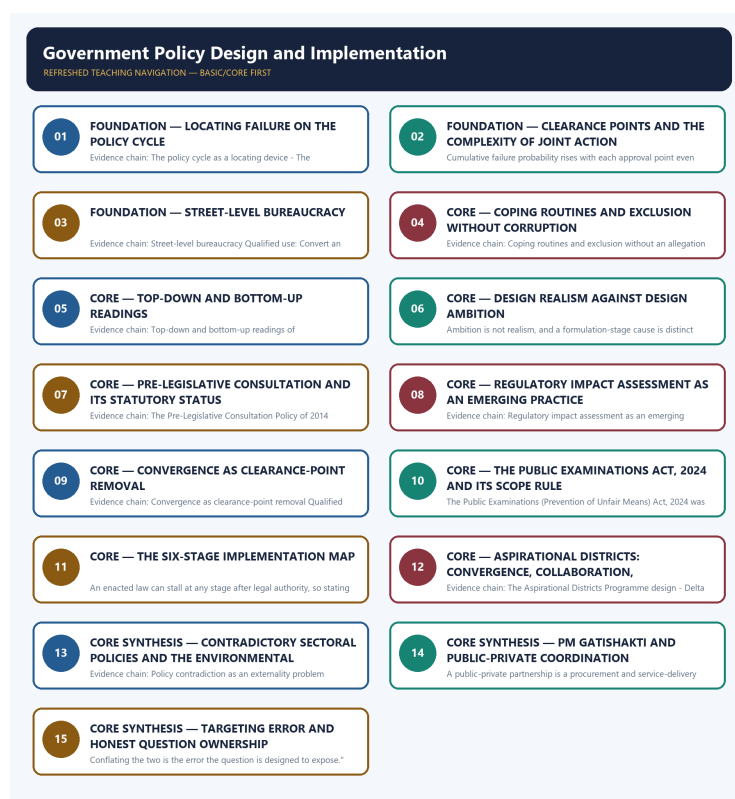


SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Government Policy Design and Implementation - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing



Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

CONTENTS / WORKBOOK INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

Government Policy Design and Implementation - Solved Practice Workbook 6

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION 6

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies The policy cycle as a locating device?	6
Q2. Which chronology card should be filed under The policy cycle as a locating device?	6
Q3. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The policy cycle as a locating device?	7
Q4. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The policy cycle as a locating device?	7
Q5. Which statement correctly identifies The implementation gap?	7
Q6. Which chronology card should be filed under The implementation gap?	8
Q7. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The implementation gap?	8
Q8. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The implementation gap?	9
Q9. Which statement correctly identifies Clearance points and the complexity of joint action?	9
Q10. Which chronology card should be filed under Clearance points and the complexity of joint action?	9
Q11. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Clearance points and the complexity of joint action?	10
Q12. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Clearance points and the complexity of joint action?	10
Q13. Which statement correctly identifies Street-level bureaucracy?	11
Q14. Which chronology card should be filed under Street-level bureaucracy?	11
Q15. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Street-level bureaucracy?	12
Q16. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Street-level bureaucracy?	12
Q17. Which statement correctly identifies Coping routines and exclusion without an allegation of corruption?	12
Q18. Which chronology card should be filed under Coping routines and exclusion without an allegation of corruption?	13
Q19. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Coping routines and exclusion without an allegation of corruption?	13
Q20. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Coping routines and exclusion without an allegation of corruption?	14
Q21. Which statement correctly identifies Top-down and bottom-up readings of implementation?	14
Q22. Which chronology card should be filed under Top-down and bottom-up readings of implementation?	14
Q23. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Top-down and bottom-up readings of implementation?	15
Q24. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Top-down and bottom-up readings of implementation?	15
Q25. Which statement correctly identifies Design realism against design ambition?	16
Q26. Which chronology card should be filed under Design realism against design ambition?	16
Q27. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Design realism against design ambition?	17

Q28. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Design realism against design ambition?	17
Q29. Which statement correctly identifies The Pre-Legislative Consultation Policy of 2014?	18
Q30. Which chronology card should be filed under The Pre-Legislative Consultation Policy of 2014?	18
Q31. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The Pre-Legislative Consultation Policy of 2014?	19
Q32. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The Pre-Legislative Consultation Policy of 2014?	19
Q33. Which statement correctly identifies Regulatory impact assessment as an emerging practice?	20
Q34. Which chronology card should be filed under Regulatory impact assessment as an emerging practice?	20
Q35. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Regulatory impact assessment as an emerging practice?	21
Q36. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Regulatory impact assessment as an emerging practice?	21
Q37. Which statement correctly identifies Convergence as clearance-point removal?	22
Q38. Which chronology card should be filed under Convergence as clearance-point removal?	22
Q39. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Convergence as clearance-point removal?	23
Q40. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Convergence as clearance-point removal?	23
Q41. Which statement correctly identifies The Public Examinations Act, 2024 and its commencement?	24
Q42. Which chronology card should be filed under The Public Examinations Act, 2024 and its commencement?	24
Q43. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The Public Examinations Act, 2024 and its commencement?	25
Q44. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The Public Examinations Act, 2024 and its commencement?	25
Q45. Which statement correctly identifies Authority-based coverage against territorial extent?	26
Q46. Which chronology card should be filed under Authority-based coverage against territorial extent?	26
Q47. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Authority-based coverage against territorial extent?	27
Q48. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Authority-based coverage against territorial extent?	28
Q49. Which statement correctly identifies The six-stage implementation map?	28
Q50. Which chronology card should be filed under The six-stage implementation map?	29
Q51. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The six-stage implementation map?	29
Q52. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The six-stage implementation map?	30
Q53. Which statement correctly identifies The Aspirational Districts Programme design?	30
Q54. Which chronology card should be filed under The Aspirational Districts Programme design?	31
Q55. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The Aspirational Districts Programme design?	31
Q56. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The Aspirational Districts Programme design?	32
Q57. Which statement correctly identifies Delta ranking and the self-reported-data limit?	33
Q58. Which chronology card should be filed under Delta ranking and the self-reported-data limit?	33
Q59. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Delta ranking and the self-reported-data limit?	34

Q60. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Delta ranking and the self-reported-data limit?	34
Q61. Which statement correctly identifies Policy contradiction as an externality problem?	35
Q62. Which chronology card should be filed under Policy contradiction as an externality problem?	35
Q63. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Policy contradiction as an externality problem?	36
Q64. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Policy contradiction as an externality problem?	36
Q65. Which statement correctly identifies PM GatiShakti as an information layer?	37
Q66. Which chronology card should be filed under PM GatiShakti as an information layer?	38
Q67. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of PM GatiShakti as an information layer?	38
Q68. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about PM GatiShakti as an information layer?	39
Q69. Which statement correctly identifies Public-private partnership governance?	39
Q70. Which chronology card should be filed under Public-private partnership governance?	40
Q71. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Public-private partnership governance?	40
Q72. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Public-private partnership governance?	41
Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Targeting error and the universalism trade-off?	41
Q74. Which chronology card should be filed under Targeting error and the universalism trade-off?	42
Q75. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Targeting error and the universalism trade-off?	42
Q76. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Targeting error and the universalism trade-off?	43
Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Verified question ownership across two ledgers?	43
Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under Verified question ownership across two ledgers?	44
Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Verified question ownership across two ledgers?	44
Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Verified question ownership across two ledgers?	45
PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE	45
VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT	45
OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS	47
PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2024 General Studies Paper-II	48
PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2018 General Studies Paper-I	50
PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2018 General Studies Paper-II	52
PYQ DEMAND CARD 4 - 2022 General Studies Paper-II	53
ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS	55
ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS	56
ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS	58
ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS	60

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS 61

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS 63

Government Policy Design and Implementation - Solved Practice Workbook

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies The policy cycle as a locating device?

A. The policy cycle - agenda setting, formulation, decision or enactment, implementation and evaluation, feeding back into agenda setting - is used analytically to locate exactly where a named policy is succeeding or failing, and the syllabus clause itself separates issues arising out of design from issues arising out of implementation. B. Pressman and Wildavsky established that each additional actor, level of government or approval step is a clearance point, and that the cumulative probability of delay or distortion rises sharply as clearance points multiply even where each individual point is separately likely to succeed, which is why a centrally sponsored scheme requiring Union, state, district and panchayat sign-off is structurally more gap-prone than a single-agency central-sector scheme. C. The implementation gap is the difference between the policy as designed or announced and the policy as actually delivered on the ground, and it is the multiplicative product of design realism, the count of independent approval points and the quality of frontline discretion rather than a synonym for corruption. D. Michael Lipsky's street-level bureaucracy thesis holds that frontline officials such as teachers, police, ration-shop dealers, auxiliary nurse midwives and examination-centre invigilators exercise substantial discretion and in effect make policy through their daily choices, so the policy a citizen experiences is what the frontline official actually does rather than what the scheme guideline says.

Answer: A. Explanation: The policy cycle - agenda setting, formulation, decision or enactment, implementation and evaluation, feeding back into agenda setting - is used analytically to locate exactly where a named policy is succeeding or failing, and the syllabus clause itself separates issues arising out of design from issues arising out of implementation. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q2. Which chronology card should be filed under The policy cycle as a locating device?

A. Michael Lipsky's street-level bureaucracy thesis holds that frontline officials such as teachers, police, ration-shop dealers, auxiliary nurse midwives and examination-centre invigilators exercise substantial discretion and in effect make policy through their daily choices, so the policy a citizen experiences is what the frontline official actually does rather than what the scheme guideline says. B. The policy cycle - agenda setting, formulation, decision or enactment, implementation and evaluation, feeding back into agenda setting - is used analytically to locate exactly where a named policy is succeeding or failing, and the syllabus clause itself separates issues arising out of design from issues arising out of implementation. C. Lipsky identifies predictable coping routines under heavy caseload and resource scarcity - rationing time and attention, creaming by serving the easier cases first, and informal rule-bending - and these routines explain welfare exclusion error without alleging corruption, which is the analytical wedge that separates a diagnosed answer from a complaint. D. Pressman and Wildavsky established that each additional actor, level of government or approval step is a clearance point, and that the cumulative probability of delay or distortion rises sharply as clearance points multiply even where each individual point is separately likely to succeed, which is why a centrally sponsored scheme requiring Union, state, district and panchayat sign-off is structurally more gap-prone than a single-agency central-sector scheme.

Answer: B. Explanation: The policy cycle - agenda setting, formulation, decision or enactment, implementation and evaluation, feeding back into agenda setting - is used analytically to locate exactly where a named policy is succeeding or failing, and the syllabus clause itself separates issues arising out of design from issues arising out of implementation. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q3. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The policy cycle as a locating device?

A. A top-down reading asks whether frontline action matched the original design while a bottom-up reading treats frontline output as the real policy regardless of design intent, and neither view alone is complete, so a strong answer reframes the question of whether an Act worked into the question of what the designated centres and officials actually did. B. Michael Lipsky's street-level bureaucracy thesis holds that frontline officials such as teachers, police, ration-shop dealers, auxiliary nurse midwives and examination-centre invigilators exercise substantial discretion and in effect make policy through their daily choices, so the policy a citizen experiences is what the frontline official actually does rather than what the scheme guideline says. C. The policy cycle - agenda setting, formulation, decision or enactment, implementation and evaluation, feeding back into agenda setting - is used analytically to locate exactly where a named policy is succeeding or failing, and the syllabus clause itself separates issues arising out of design from issues arising out of implementation. D. Lipsky identifies predictable coping routines under heavy caseload and resource scarcity - rationing time and attention, creaming by serving the easier cases first, and informal rule-bending - and these routines explain welfare exclusion error without alleging corruption, which is the analytical wedge that separates a diagnosed answer from a complaint.

Answer: C. Explanation: The policy cycle - agenda setting, formulation, decision or enactment, implementation and evaluation, feeding back into agenda setting - is used analytically to locate exactly where a named policy is succeeding or failing, and the syllabus clause itself separates issues arising out of design from issues arising out of implementation. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q4. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The policy cycle as a locating device?

A. A top-down reading asks whether frontline action matched the original design while a bottom-up reading treats frontline output as the real policy regardless of design intent, and neither view alone is complete, so a strong answer reframes the question of whether an Act worked into the question of what the designated centres and officials actually did. B. A policy can be ambitious in coverage and targets without being realistic against actual administrative capacity, and the gap between ambition and realism is a formulation-stage cause of failure distinct from any delivery-stage cause, so most failures attributed to implementation are in fact design failures that became visible only at delivery. C. Lipsky identifies predictable coping routines under heavy caseload and resource scarcity - rationing time and attention, creaming by serving the easier cases first, and informal rule-bending - and these routines explain welfare exclusion error without alleging corruption, which is the analytical wedge that separates a diagnosed answer from a complaint. D. The policy cycle - agenda setting, formulation, decision or enactment, implementation and evaluation, feeding back into agenda setting - is used analytically to locate exactly where a named policy is succeeding or failing, and the syllabus clause itself separates issues arising out of design from issues arising out of implementation.

Answer: D. Explanation: The policy cycle - agenda setting, formulation, decision or enactment, implementation and evaluation, feeding back into agenda setting - is used analytically to locate exactly where a named policy is succeeding or failing, and the syllabus clause itself separates issues arising out of design from issues arising out of implementation. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q5. Which statement correctly identifies The implementation gap?

A. The implementation gap is the difference between the policy as designed or announced and the policy as actually delivered on the ground, and it is the multiplicative product of design realism, the count of independent approval points and the quality of frontline discretion rather than a synonym for corruption. B. Pressman and Wildavsky established that each additional actor, level of government or approval step is a clearance point, and that the cumulative probability of delay or distortion rises sharply as clearance points multiply even where each individual point is separately likely to succeed, which is why a centrally sponsored scheme requiring Union, state, district and panchayat sign-off is structurally more gap-prone than a single-agency central-sector scheme. C. Lipsky identifies predictable coping routines under heavy caseload and resource scarcity - rationing time and attention, creaming by serving the easier cases first, and informal rule-bending - and these routines explain welfare exclusion error without alleging corruption, which is the analytical wedge that separates a diagnosed answer from a complaint. D. Michael Lipsky's street-level bureaucracy thesis holds that frontline officials such as teachers, police, ration-shop dealers, auxiliary

nurse midwives and examination-centre invigilators exercise substantial discretion and in effect make policy through their daily choices, so the policy a citizen experiences is what the frontline official actually does rather than what the scheme guideline says.

Answer: A. Explanation: The implementation gap is the difference between the policy as designed or announced and the policy as actually delivered on the ground, and it is the multiplicative product of design realism, the count of independent approval points and the quality of frontline discretion rather than a synonym for corruption. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q6. Which chronology card should be filed under The implementation gap?

A. A top-down reading asks whether frontline action matched the original design while a bottom-up reading treats frontline output as the real policy regardless of design intent, and neither view alone is complete, so a strong answer reframes the question of whether an Act worked into the question of what the designated centres and officials actually did. B. The implementation gap is the difference between the policy as designed or announced and the policy as actually delivered on the ground, and it is the multiplicative product of design realism, the count of independent approval points and the quality of frontline discretion rather than a synonym for corruption. C. Michael Lipsky's street-level bureaucracy thesis holds that frontline officials such as teachers, police, ration-shop dealers, auxiliary nurse midwives and examination-centre invigilators exercise substantial discretion and in effect make policy through their daily choices, so the policy a citizen experiences is what the frontline official actually does rather than what the scheme guideline says. D. Lipsky identifies predictable coping routines under heavy caseload and resource scarcity - rationing time and attention, creaming by serving the easier cases first, and informal rule-bending - and these routines explain welfare exclusion error without alleging corruption, which is the analytical wedge that separates a diagnosed answer from a complaint.

Answer: B. Explanation: The implementation gap is the difference between the policy as designed or announced and the policy as actually delivered on the ground, and it is the multiplicative product of design realism, the count of independent approval points and the quality of frontline discretion rather than a synonym for corruption. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q7. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The implementation gap?

A. Lipsky identifies predictable coping routines under heavy caseload and resource scarcity - rationing time and attention, creaming by serving the easier cases first, and informal rule-bending - and these routines explain welfare exclusion error without alleging corruption, which is the analytical wedge that separates a diagnosed answer from a complaint. B. A policy can be ambitious in coverage and targets without being realistic against actual administrative capacity, and the gap between ambition and realism is a formulation-stage cause of failure distinct from any delivery-stage cause, so most failures attributed to implementation are in fact design failures that became visible only at delivery. C. The implementation gap is the difference between the policy as designed or announced and the policy as actually delivered on the ground, and it is the multiplicative product of design realism, the count of independent approval points and the quality of frontline discretion rather than a synonym for corruption. D. A top-down reading asks whether frontline action matched the original design while a bottom-up reading treats frontline output as the real policy regardless of design intent, and neither view alone is complete, so a strong answer reframes the question of whether an Act worked into the question of what the designated centres and officials actually did.

Answer: C. Explanation: The implementation gap is the difference between the policy as designed or announced and the policy as actually delivered on the ground, and it is the multiplicative product of design realism, the count of independent approval points and the quality of frontline discretion rather than a synonym for corruption. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q8. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The implementation gap?

A. A top-down reading asks whether frontline action matched the original design while a bottom-up reading treats frontline output as the real policy regardless of design intent, and neither view alone is complete, so a strong answer reframes the question of whether an Act worked into the question of what the designated centres and officials actually did. B. A policy can be ambitious in coverage and targets without being realistic against actual administrative capacity, and the gap between ambition and realism is a formulation-stage cause of failure distinct from any delivery-stage cause, so most failures attributed to implementation are in fact design failures that became visible only at delivery. C. The Pre-Legislative Consultation Policy of 2014 advises Union departments to publish draft legislation with an explanatory note and an ordinary minimum public comment window of about thirty days before introduction, and it is an executive policy rather than a statute whose comments are not binding, so publishing a draft is consultation compliance while incorporating feedback is consultation depth. D. The implementation gap is the difference between the policy as designed or announced and the policy as actually delivered on the ground, and it is the multiplicative product of design realism, the count of independent approval points and the quality of frontline discretion rather than a synonym for corruption.

Answer: D. Explanation: The implementation gap is the difference between the policy as designed or announced and the policy as actually delivered on the ground, and it is the multiplicative product of design realism, the count of independent approval points and the quality of frontline discretion rather than a synonym for corruption. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q9. Which statement correctly identifies Clearance points and the complexity of joint action?

A. Pressman and Wildavsky established that each additional actor, level of government or approval step is a clearance point, and that the cumulative probability of delay or distortion rises sharply as clearance points multiply even where each individual point is separately likely to succeed, which is why a centrally sponsored scheme requiring Union, state, district and panchayat sign-off is structurally more gap-prone than a single-agency central-sector scheme. B. Lipsky identifies predictable coping routines under heavy caseload and resource scarcity - rationing time and attention, creaming by serving the easier cases first, and informal rule-bending - and these routines explain welfare exclusion error without alleging corruption, which is the analytical wedge that separates a diagnosed answer from a complaint. C. Michael Lipsky's street-level bureaucracy thesis holds that frontline officials such as teachers, police, ration-shop dealers, auxiliary nurse midwives and examination-centre invigilators exercise substantial discretion and in effect make policy through their daily choices, so the policy a citizen experiences is what the frontline official actually does rather than what the scheme guideline says. D. A top-down reading asks whether frontline action matched the original design while a bottom-up reading treats frontline output as the real policy regardless of design intent, and neither view alone is complete, so a strong answer reframes the question of whether an Act worked into the question of what the designated centres and officials actually did.

Answer: A. Explanation: Pressman and Wildavsky established that each additional actor, level of government or approval step is a clearance point, and that the cumulative probability of delay or distortion rises sharply as clearance points multiply even where each individual point is separately likely to succeed, which is why a centrally sponsored scheme requiring Union, state, district and panchayat sign-off is structurally more gap-prone than a single-agency central-sector scheme. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q10. Which chronology card should be filed under Clearance points and the complexity of joint action?

A. A top-down reading asks whether frontline action matched the original design while a bottom-up reading treats frontline output as the real policy regardless of design intent, and neither view alone is complete, so a strong answer reframes the question of whether an Act worked into the question of what the designated centres and officials actually did. B. Pressman and Wildavsky established that each additional actor, level of government or approval step is a clearance point, and that the cumulative probability of delay or distortion rises sharply as clearance points multiply even where each individual point is separately likely to succeed, which is why a centrally sponsored scheme requiring Union, state, district and panchayat sign-off is structurally more gap-prone than a single-agency central-sector scheme. C. Lipsky identifies predictable coping routines under heavy caseload and resource scarcity - rationing time and attention, creaming by serving the easier cases first, and informal rule-bending - and these routines explain

welfare exclusion error without alleging corruption, which is the analytical wedge that separates a diagnosed answer from a complaint. D. A policy can be ambitious in coverage and targets without being realistic against actual administrative capacity, and the gap between ambition and realism is a formulation-stage cause of failure distinct from any delivery-stage cause, so most failures attributed to implementation are in fact design failures that became visible only at delivery.

Answer: B. Explanation: Pressman and Wildavsky established that each additional actor, level of government or approval step is a clearance point, and that the cumulative probability of delay or distortion rises sharply as clearance points multiply even where each individual point is separately likely to succeed, which is why a centrally sponsored scheme requiring Union, state, district and panchayat sign-off is structurally more gap-prone than a single-agency central-sector scheme. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q11. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Clearance points and the complexity of joint action?

A. The Pre-Legislative Consultation Policy of 2014 advises Union departments to publish draft legislation with an explanatory note and an ordinary minimum public comment window of about thirty days before introduction, and it is an executive policy rather than a statute whose comments are not binding, so publishing a draft is consultation compliance while incorporating feedback is consultation depth. B. A policy can be ambitious in coverage and targets without being realistic against actual administrative capacity, and the gap between ambition and realism is a formulation-stage cause of failure distinct from any delivery-stage cause, so most failures attributed to implementation are in fact design failures that became visible only at delivery. C. Pressman and Wildavsky established that each additional actor, level of government or approval step is a clearance point, and that the cumulative probability of delay or distortion rises sharply as clearance points multiply even where each individual point is separately likely to succeed, which is why a centrally sponsored scheme requiring Union, state, district and panchayat sign-off is structurally more gap-prone than a single-agency central-sector scheme. D. A top-down reading asks whether frontline action matched the original design while a bottom-up reading treats frontline output as the real policy regardless of design intent, and neither view alone is complete, so a strong answer reframes the question of whether an Act worked into the question of what the designated centres and officials actually did.

Answer: C. Explanation: Pressman and Wildavsky established that each additional actor, level of government or approval step is a clearance point, and that the cumulative probability of delay or distortion rises sharply as clearance points multiply even where each individual point is separately likely to succeed, which is why a centrally sponsored scheme requiring Union, state, district and panchayat sign-off is structurally more gap-prone than a single-agency central-sector scheme. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q12. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Clearance points and the complexity of joint action?

A. The Pre-Legislative Consultation Policy of 2014 advises Union departments to publish draft legislation with an explanatory note and an ordinary minimum public comment window of about thirty days before introduction, and it is an executive policy rather than a statute whose comments are not binding, so publishing a draft is consultation compliance while incorporating feedback is consultation depth. B. A policy can be ambitious in coverage and targets without being realistic against actual administrative capacity, and the gap between ambition and realism is a formulation-stage cause of failure distinct from any delivery-stage cause, so most failures attributed to implementation are in fact design failures that became visible only at delivery. C. A regulatory impact assessment is a structured ex-ante assessment of a proposed regulation's costs, benefits and alternatives before it is finalised, and it remains unevenly institutionalised across Indian ministries and regulators, so it must be cited as an emerging good-governance practice rather than as a uniformly binding legal requirement. D. Pressman and Wildavsky established that each additional actor, level of government or approval step is a clearance point, and that the cumulative probability of delay or distortion rises sharply as clearance points multiply even where each individual point is separately likely to succeed, which is why a centrally sponsored scheme requiring Union, state, district and panchayat sign-off is structurally more gap-prone than a single-agency central-sector scheme.

Answer: D. Explanation: Pressman and Wildavsky established that each additional actor, level of government or approval step is a clearance point, and that the cumulative probability of delay or distortion rises sharply as clearance points multiply even where each individual point is separately likely to succeed, which is why a centrally sponsored scheme requiring Union, state, district and panchayat sign-off is structurally more gap-prone than a single-agency central-sector scheme. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q13. Which statement correctly identifies Street-level bureaucracy?

A. Michael Lipsky's street-level bureaucracy thesis holds that frontline officials such as teachers, police, ration-shop dealers, auxiliary nurse midwives and examination-centre invigilators exercise substantial discretion and in effect make policy through their daily choices, so the policy a citizen experiences is what the frontline official actually does rather than what the scheme guideline says. B. A policy can be ambitious in coverage and targets without being realistic against actual administrative capacity, and the gap between ambition and realism is a formulation-stage cause of failure distinct from any delivery-stage cause, so most failures attributed to implementation are in fact design failures that became visible only at delivery. C. A top-down reading asks whether frontline action matched the original design while a bottom-up reading treats frontline output as the real policy regardless of design intent, and neither view alone is complete, so a strong answer reframes the question of whether an Act worked into the question of what the designated centres and officials actually did. D. Lipsky identifies predictable coping routines under heavy caseload and resource scarcity - rationing time and attention, creaming by serving the easier cases first, and informal rule-bending - and these routines explain welfare exclusion error without alleging corruption, which is the analytical wedge that separates a diagnosed answer from a complaint.

Answer: A. Explanation: Michael Lipsky's street-level bureaucracy thesis holds that frontline officials such as teachers, police, ration-shop dealers, auxiliary nurse midwives and examination-centre invigilators exercise substantial discretion and in effect make policy through their daily choices, so the policy a citizen experiences is what the frontline official actually does rather than what the scheme guideline says. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q14. Which chronology card should be filed under Street-level bureaucracy?

A. The Pre-Legislative Consultation Policy of 2014 advises Union departments to publish draft legislation with an explanatory note and an ordinary minimum public comment window of about thirty days before introduction, and it is an executive policy rather than a statute whose comments are not binding, so publishing a draft is consultation compliance while incorporating feedback is consultation depth. B. Michael Lipsky's street-level bureaucracy thesis holds that frontline officials such as teachers, police, ration-shop dealers, auxiliary nurse midwives and examination-centre invigilators exercise substantial discretion and in effect make policy through their daily choices, so the policy a citizen experiences is what the frontline official actually does rather than what the scheme guideline says. C. A policy can be ambitious in coverage and targets without being realistic against actual administrative capacity, and the gap between ambition and realism is a formulation-stage cause of failure distinct from any delivery-stage cause, so most failures attributed to implementation are in fact design failures that became visible only at delivery. D. A top-down reading asks whether frontline action matched the original design while a bottom-up reading treats frontline output as the real policy regardless of design intent, and neither view alone is complete, so a strong answer reframes the question of whether an Act worked into the question of what the designated centres and officials actually did.

Answer: B. Explanation: Michael Lipsky's street-level bureaucracy thesis holds that frontline officials such as teachers, police, ration-shop dealers, auxiliary nurse midwives and examination-centre invigilators exercise substantial discretion and in effect make policy through their daily choices, so the policy a citizen experiences is what the frontline official actually does rather than what the scheme guideline says. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q15. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Street-level bureaucracy?

A. A policy can be ambitious in coverage and targets without being realistic against actual administrative capacity, and the gap between ambition and realism is a formulation-stage cause of failure distinct from any delivery-stage cause, so most failures attributed to implementation are in fact design failures that became visible only at delivery. B. The Pre-Legislative Consultation Policy of 2014 advises Union departments to publish draft legislation with an explanatory note and an ordinary minimum public comment window of about thirty days before introduction, and it is an executive policy rather than a statute whose comments are not binding, so publishing a draft is consultation compliance while incorporating feedback is consultation depth. C. Michael Lipsky's street-level bureaucracy thesis holds that frontline officials such as teachers, police, ration-shop dealers, auxiliary nurse midwives and examination-centre invigilators exercise substantial discretion and in effect make policy through their daily choices, so the policy a citizen experiences is what the frontline official actually does rather than what the scheme guideline says. D. A regulatory impact assessment is a structured ex-ante assessment of a proposed regulation's costs, benefits and alternatives before it is finalised, and it remains unevenly institutionalised across Indian ministries and regulators, so it must be cited as an emerging good-governance practice rather than as a uniformly binding legal requirement.

Answer: C. Explanation: Michael Lipsky's street-level bureaucracy thesis holds that frontline officials such as teachers, police, ration-shop dealers, auxiliary nurse midwives and examination-centre invigilators exercise substantial discretion and in effect make policy through their daily choices, so the policy a citizen experiences is what the frontline official actually does rather than what the scheme guideline says. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q16. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Street-level bureaucracy?

A. A regulatory impact assessment is a structured ex-ante assessment of a proposed regulation's costs, benefits and alternatives before it is finalised, and it remains unevenly institutionalised across Indian ministries and regulators, so it must be cited as an emerging good-governance practice rather than as a uniformly binding legal requirement. B. Convergence is the deliberate alignment of multiple schemes and departments toward a common local outcome, and its analytical value is that it adds no new scheme but removes clearance points and duplicate targeting between existing ones at the district and panchayat level, which is why it improves outcomes without a proportional increase in outlay and why it fails wherever functional devolution is absent. C. The Pre-Legislative Consultation Policy of 2014 advises Union departments to publish draft legislation with an explanatory note and an ordinary minimum public comment window of about thirty days before introduction, and it is an executive policy rather than a statute whose comments are not binding, so publishing a draft is consultation compliance while incorporating feedback is consultation depth. D. Michael Lipsky's street-level bureaucracy thesis holds that frontline officials such as teachers, police, ration-shop dealers, auxiliary nurse midwives and examination-centre invigilators exercise substantial discretion and in effect make policy through their daily choices, so the policy a citizen experiences is what the frontline official actually does rather than what the scheme guideline says.

Answer: D. Explanation: Michael Lipsky's street-level bureaucracy thesis holds that frontline officials such as teachers, police, ration-shop dealers, auxiliary nurse midwives and examination-centre invigilators exercise substantial discretion and in effect make policy through their daily choices, so the policy a citizen experiences is what the frontline official actually does rather than what the scheme guideline says. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q17. Which statement correctly identifies Coping routines and exclusion without an allegation of corruption?

A. Lipsky identifies predictable coping routines under heavy caseload and resource scarcity - rationing time and attention, creaming by serving the easier cases first, and informal rule-bending - and these routines explain welfare exclusion error without alleging corruption, which is the analytical wedge that separates a diagnosed answer from a complaint. B. A policy can be ambitious in coverage and targets without being realistic against actual administrative capacity, and the gap between ambition and realism is a formulation-stage cause of failure distinct from any delivery-stage cause, so most failures attributed to implementation are in fact design failures that became visible only at delivery. C. A top-down reading asks whether frontline action matched the original design while a bottom-up reading treats frontline output as the real policy regardless of design intent, and neither view alone is complete, so a strong answer reframes the question of whether an Act worked into the question of what the designated centres and officials

actually did. D. The Pre-Legislative Consultation Policy of 2014 advises Union departments to publish draft legislation with an explanatory note and an ordinary minimum public comment window of about thirty days before introduction, and it is an executive policy rather than a statute whose comments are not binding, so publishing a draft is consultation compliance while incorporating feedback is consultation depth.

Answer: A. Explanation: Lipsky identifies predictable coping routines under heavy caseload and resource scarcity - rationing time and attention, creaming by serving the easier cases first, and informal rule-bending - and these routines explain welfare exclusion error without alleging corruption, which is the analytical wedge that separates a diagnosed answer from a complaint. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q18. Which chronology card should be filed under Coping routines and exclusion without an allegation of corruption?

A. A policy can be ambitious in coverage and targets without being realistic against actual administrative capacity, and the gap between ambition and realism is a formulation-stage cause of failure distinct from any delivery-stage cause, so most failures attributed to implementation are in fact design failures that became visible only at delivery. B. Lipsky identifies predictable coping routines under heavy caseload and resource scarcity - rationing time and attention, creaming by serving the easier cases first, and informal rule-bending - and these routines explain welfare exclusion error without alleging corruption, which is the analytical wedge that separates a diagnosed answer from a complaint. C. A regulatory impact assessment is a structured ex-ante assessment of a proposed regulation's costs, benefits and alternatives before it is finalised, and it remains unevenly institutionalised across Indian ministries and regulators, so it must be cited as an emerging good-governance practice rather than as a uniformly binding legal requirement. D. The Pre-Legislative Consultation Policy of 2014 advises Union departments to publish draft legislation with an explanatory note and an ordinary minimum public comment window of about thirty days before introduction, and it is an executive policy rather than a statute whose comments are not binding, so publishing a draft is consultation compliance while incorporating feedback is consultation depth.

Answer: B. Explanation: Lipsky identifies predictable coping routines under heavy caseload and resource scarcity - rationing time and attention, creaming by serving the easier cases first, and informal rule-bending - and these routines explain welfare exclusion error without alleging corruption, which is the analytical wedge that separates a diagnosed answer from a complaint. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q19. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Coping routines and exclusion without an allegation of corruption?

A. Convergence is the deliberate alignment of multiple schemes and departments toward a common local outcome, and its analytical value is that it adds no new scheme but removes clearance points and duplicate targeting between existing ones at the district and panchayat level, which is why it improves outcomes without a proportional increase in outlay and why it fails wherever functional devolution is absent. B. A regulatory impact assessment is a structured ex-ante assessment of a proposed regulation's costs, benefits and alternatives before it is finalised, and it remains unevenly institutionalised across Indian ministries and regulators, so it must be cited as an emerging good-governance practice rather than as a uniformly binding legal requirement. C. Lipsky identifies predictable coping routines under heavy caseload and resource scarcity - rationing time and attention, creaming by serving the easier cases first, and informal rule-bending - and these routines explain welfare exclusion error without alleging corruption, which is the analytical wedge that separates a diagnosed answer from a complaint. D. The Pre-Legislative Consultation Policy of 2014 advises Union departments to publish draft legislation with an explanatory note and an ordinary minimum public comment window of about thirty days before introduction, and it is an executive policy rather than a statute whose comments are not binding, so publishing a draft is consultation compliance while incorporating feedback is consultation depth.

Answer: C. Explanation: Lipsky identifies predictable coping routines under heavy caseload and resource scarcity - rationing time and attention, creaming by serving the easier cases first, and informal rule-bending - and these routines explain welfare exclusion error without alleging corruption, which is the analytical wedge that separates a diagnosed answer from a complaint. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q20. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Coping routines and exclusion without an allegation of corruption?

A. Convergence is the deliberate alignment of multiple schemes and departments toward a common local outcome, and its analytical value is that it adds no new scheme but removes clearance points and duplicate targeting between existing ones at the district and panchayat level, which is why it improves outcomes without a proportional increase in outlay and why it fails wherever functional devolution is absent. B. The Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 was enacted to prevent and penalise unfair means such as question-paper leaks, impersonation and tampering in public examinations, it came into force on 21 June 2024 by notification S.O. 2422(E), and its scheduled central authorities include the Union Public Service Commission, the Staff Selection Commission, Railway Recruitment Boards, the Institute of Banking Personnel Selection, Central Government departments and attached offices, and the National Testing Agency. C. A regulatory impact assessment is a structured ex-ante assessment of a proposed regulation's costs, benefits and alternatives before it is finalised, and it remains unevenly institutionalised across Indian ministries and regulators, so it must be cited as an emerging good-governance practice rather than as a uniformly binding legal requirement. D. Lipsky identifies predictable coping routines under heavy caseload and resource scarcity - rationing time and attention, creaming by serving the easier cases first, and informal rule-bending - and these routines explain welfare exclusion error without alleging corruption, which is the analytical wedge that separates a diagnosed answer from a complaint.

Answer: D. Explanation: Lipsky identifies predictable coping routines under heavy caseload and resource scarcity - rationing time and attention, creaming by serving the easier cases first, and informal rule-bending - and these routines explain welfare exclusion error without alleging corruption, which is the analytical wedge that separates a diagnosed answer from a complaint. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q21. Which statement correctly identifies Top-down and bottom-up readings of implementation?

A. A top-down reading asks whether frontline action matched the original design while a bottom-up reading treats frontline output as the real policy regardless of design intent, and neither view alone is complete, so a strong answer reframes the question of whether an Act worked into the question of what the designated centres and officials actually did. B. A policy can be ambitious in coverage and targets without being realistic against actual administrative capacity, and the gap between ambition and realism is a formulation-stage cause of failure distinct from any delivery-stage cause, so most failures attributed to implementation are in fact design failures that became visible only at delivery. C. A regulatory impact assessment is a structured ex-ante assessment of a proposed regulation's costs, benefits and alternatives before it is finalised, and it remains unevenly institutionalised across Indian ministries and regulators, so it must be cited as an emerging good-governance practice rather than as a uniformly binding legal requirement. D. The Pre-Legislative Consultation Policy of 2014 advises Union departments to publish draft legislation with an explanatory note and an ordinary minimum public comment window of about thirty days before introduction, and it is an executive policy rather than a statute whose comments are not binding, so publishing a draft is consultation compliance while incorporating feedback is consultation depth.

Answer: A. Explanation: A top-down reading asks whether frontline action matched the original design while a bottom-up reading treats frontline output as the real policy regardless of design intent, and neither view alone is complete, so a strong answer reframes the question of whether an Act worked into the question of what the designated centres and officials actually did. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q22. Which chronology card should be filed under Top-down and bottom-up readings of implementation?

A. A regulatory impact assessment is a structured ex-ante assessment of a proposed regulation's costs, benefits and alternatives before it is finalised, and it remains unevenly institutionalised across Indian ministries and regulators, so it must be cited as an emerging good-governance practice rather than as a uniformly binding legal requirement. B. A top-down reading asks whether frontline action matched the original design while a bottom-up reading treats frontline output as the real policy regardless of design intent, and neither view alone is complete, so a strong answer reframes the question of whether an Act worked into the question of what the designated centres and officials actually did. C. Convergence is the deliberate alignment of multiple schemes and departments toward a common local outcome, and

its analytical value is that it adds no new scheme but removes clearance points and duplicate targeting between existing ones at the district and panchayat level, which is why it improves outcomes without a proportional increase in outlay and why it fails wherever functional devolution is absent. D. The Pre-Legislative Consultation Policy of 2014 advises Union departments to publish draft legislation with an explanatory note and an ordinary minimum public comment window of about thirty days before introduction, and it is an executive policy rather than a statute whose comments are not binding, so publishing a draft is consultation compliance while incorporating feedback is consultation depth.

Answer: B. Explanation: A top-down reading asks whether frontline action matched the original design while a bottom-up reading treats frontline output as the real policy regardless of design intent, and neither view alone is complete, so a strong answer reframes the question of whether an Act worked into the question of what the designated centres and officials actually did. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q23. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Top-down and bottom-up readings of implementation?

A. Convergence is the deliberate alignment of multiple schemes and departments toward a common local outcome, and its analytical value is that it adds no new scheme but removes clearance points and duplicate targeting between existing ones at the district and panchayat level, which is why it improves outcomes without a proportional increase in outlay and why it fails wherever functional devolution is absent. B. The Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 was enacted to prevent and penalise unfair means such as question-paper leaks, impersonation and tampering in public examinations, it came into force on 21 June 2024 by notification S.O. 2422(E), and its scheduled central authorities include the Union Public Service Commission, the Staff Selection Commission, Railway Recruitment Boards, the Institute of Banking Personnel Selection, Central Government departments and attached offices, and the National Testing Agency. C. A top-down reading asks whether frontline action matched the original design while a bottom-up reading treats frontline output as the real policy regardless of design intent, and neither view alone is complete, so a strong answer reframes the question of whether an Act worked into the question of what the designated centres and officials actually did. D. A regulatory impact assessment is a structured ex-ante assessment of a proposed regulation's costs, benefits and alternatives before it is finalised, and it remains unevenly institutionalised across Indian ministries and regulators, so it must be cited as an emerging good-governance practice rather than as a uniformly binding legal requirement.

Answer: C. Explanation: A top-down reading asks whether frontline action matched the original design while a bottom-up reading treats frontline output as the real policy regardless of design intent, and neither view alone is complete, so a strong answer reframes the question of whether an Act worked into the question of what the designated centres and officials actually did. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q24. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Top-down and bottom-up readings of implementation?

A. The Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 was enacted to prevent and penalise unfair means such as question-paper leaks, impersonation and tampering in public examinations, it came into force on 21 June 2024 by notification S.O. 2422(E), and its scheduled central authorities include the Union Public Service Commission, the Staff Selection Commission, Railway Recruitment Boards, the Institute of Banking Personnel Selection, Central Government departments and attached offices, and the National Testing Agency. B. Convergence is the deliberate alignment of multiple schemes and departments toward a common local outcome, and its analytical value is that it adds no new scheme but removes clearance points and duplicate targeting between existing ones at the district and panchayat level, which is why it improves outcomes without a proportional increase in outlay and why it fails wherever functional devolution is absent. C. Coverage under the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 is authority-based rather than subject-matter-based or territorial, so a state board or university examination is not automatically covered merely because the Act extends to India, and inclusion requires either notification of that authority by the Central Government or separate state legislation, which is precisely the scope half of the 2024 demand and the point an aims-only answer misses. D. A top-down reading asks whether frontline action matched the original design while a bottom-up reading treats frontline output as the real policy regardless of design intent, and neither view alone is complete, so a strong answer reframes the question of whether an Act worked into

the question of what the designated centres and officials actually did.

Answer: D. Explanation: A top-down reading asks whether frontline action matched the original design while a bottom-up reading treats frontline output as the real policy regardless of design intent, and neither view alone is complete, so a strong answer reframes the question of whether an Act worked into the question of what the designated centres and officials actually did. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q25. Which statement correctly identifies Design realism against design ambition?

A. A policy can be ambitious in coverage and targets without being realistic against actual administrative capacity, and the gap between ambition and realism is a formulation-stage cause of failure distinct from any delivery-stage cause, so most failures attributed to implementation are in fact design failures that became visible only at delivery. B. The Pre-Legislative Consultation Policy of 2014 advises Union departments to publish draft legislation with an explanatory note and an ordinary minimum public comment window of about thirty days before introduction, and it is an executive policy rather than a statute whose comments are not binding, so publishing a draft is consultation compliance while incorporating feedback is consultation depth. C. Convergence is the deliberate alignment of multiple schemes and departments toward a common local outcome, and its analytical value is that it adds no new scheme but removes clearance points and duplicate targeting between existing ones at the district and panchayat level, which is why it improves outcomes without a proportional increase in outlay and why it fails wherever functional devolution is absent. D. A regulatory impact assessment is a structured ex-ante assessment of a proposed regulation's costs, benefits and alternatives before it is finalised, and it remains unevenly institutionalised across Indian ministries and regulators, so it must be cited as an emerging good-governance practice rather than as a uniformly binding legal requirement.

Answer: A. Explanation: A policy can be ambitious in coverage and targets without being realistic against actual administrative capacity, and the gap between ambition and realism is a formulation-stage cause of failure distinct from any delivery-stage cause, so most failures attributed to implementation are in fact design failures that became visible only at delivery. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q26. Which chronology card should be filed under Design realism against design ambition?

A. A regulatory impact assessment is a structured ex-ante assessment of a proposed regulation's costs, benefits and alternatives before it is finalised, and it remains unevenly institutionalised across Indian ministries and regulators, so it must be cited as an emerging good-governance practice rather than as a uniformly binding legal requirement. B. A policy can be ambitious in coverage and targets without being realistic against actual administrative capacity, and the gap between ambition and realism is a formulation-stage cause of failure distinct from any delivery-stage cause, so most failures attributed to implementation are in fact design failures that became visible only at delivery. C. Convergence is the deliberate alignment of multiple schemes and departments toward a common local outcome, and its analytical value is that it adds no new scheme but removes clearance points and duplicate targeting between existing ones at the district and panchayat level, which is why it improves outcomes without a proportional increase in outlay and why it fails wherever functional devolution is absent. D. The Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 was enacted to prevent and penalise unfair means such as question-paper leaks, impersonation and tampering in public examinations, it came into force on 21 June 2024 by notification S.O. 2422(E), and its scheduled central authorities include the Union Public Service Commission, the Staff Selection Commission, Railway Recruitment Boards, the Institute of Banking Personnel Selection, Central Government departments and attached offices, and the National Testing Agency.

Answer: B. Explanation: A policy can be ambitious in coverage and targets without being realistic against actual administrative capacity, and the gap between ambition and realism is a formulation-stage cause of failure distinct from any delivery-stage cause, so most failures attributed to implementation are in fact design failures that became visible only at delivery. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q27. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Design realism against design ambition?

A. Coverage under the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 is authority-based rather than subject-matter-based or territorial, so a state board or university examination is not automatically covered merely because the Act extends to India, and inclusion requires either notification of that authority by the Central Government or separate state legislation, which is precisely the scope half of the 2024 demand and the point an aims-only answer misses. B. The Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 was enacted to prevent and penalise unfair means such as question-paper leaks, impersonation and tampering in public examinations, it came into force on 21 June 2024 by notification S.O. 2422(E), and its scheduled central authorities include the Union Public Service Commission, the Staff Selection Commission, Railway Recruitment Boards, the Institute of Banking Personnel Selection, Central Government departments and attached offices, and the National Testing Agency. C. A policy can be ambitious in coverage and targets without being realistic against actual administrative capacity, and the gap between ambition and realism is a formulation-stage cause of failure distinct from any delivery-stage cause, so most failures attributed to implementation are in fact design failures that became visible only at delivery. D. Convergence is the deliberate alignment of multiple schemes and departments toward a common local outcome, and its analytical value is that it adds no new scheme but removes clearance points and duplicate targeting between existing ones at the district and panchayat level, which is why it improves outcomes without a proportional increase in outlay and why it fails wherever functional devolution is absent.

Answer: C. Explanation: A policy can be ambitious in coverage and targets without being realistic against actual administrative capacity, and the gap between ambition and realism is a formulation-stage cause of failure distinct from any delivery-stage cause, so most failures attributed to implementation are in fact design failures that became visible only at delivery. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q28. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Design realism against design ambition?

A. The Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 was enacted to prevent and penalise unfair means such as question-paper leaks, impersonation and tampering in public examinations, it came into force on 21 June 2024 by notification S.O. 2422(E), and its scheduled central authorities include the Union Public Service Commission, the Staff Selection Commission, Railway Recruitment Boards, the Institute of Banking Personnel Selection, Central Government departments and attached offices, and the National Testing Agency. B. Any unfamiliar policy can be diagnosed through six stages - legal authority and who is bound, rules and standard operating procedures specifying entitlement and eligibility, the named responsible agency across Union, state, district, local or parastatal levels, staff and money and technology including sanctioned against filled posts and the fund-flow route, the citizen interface of awareness and documents and distance and language and digital access, and grievance and review including appeal, penalty, evaluation and any sunset clause - and an enacted law can stall at any stage after the first. C. Coverage under the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 is authority-based rather than subject-matter-based or territorial, so a state board or university examination is not automatically covered merely because the Act extends to India, and inclusion requires either notification of that authority by the Central Government or separate state legislation, which is precisely the scope half of the 2024 demand and the point an aims-only answer misses. D. A policy can be ambitious in coverage and targets without being realistic against actual administrative capacity, and the gap between ambition and realism is a formulation-stage cause of failure distinct from any delivery-stage cause, so most failures attributed to implementation are in fact design failures that became visible only at delivery.

Answer: D. Explanation: A policy can be ambitious in coverage and targets without being realistic against actual administrative capacity, and the gap between ambition and realism is a formulation-stage cause of failure distinct from any delivery-stage cause, so most failures attributed to implementation are in fact design failures that became visible only at delivery. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q29. Which statement correctly identifies The Pre-Legislative Consultation Policy of 2014?

A. The Pre-Legislative Consultation Policy of 2014 advises Union departments to publish draft legislation with an explanatory note and an ordinary minimum public comment window of about thirty days before introduction, and it is an executive policy rather than a statute whose comments are not binding, so publishing a draft is consultation compliance while incorporating feedback is consultation depth. B. The Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 was enacted to prevent and penalise unfair means such as question-paper leaks, impersonation and tampering in public examinations, it came into force on 21 June 2024 by notification S.O. 2422(E), and its scheduled central authorities include the Union Public Service Commission, the Staff Selection Commission, Railway Recruitment Boards, the Institute of Banking Personnel Selection, Central Government departments and attached offices, and the National Testing Agency. C. Convergence is the deliberate alignment of multiple schemes and departments toward a common local outcome, and its analytical value is that it adds no new scheme but removes clearance points and duplicate targeting between existing ones at the district and panchayat level, which is why it improves outcomes without a proportional increase in outlay and why it fails wherever functional devolution is absent. D. A regulatory impact assessment is a structured ex-ante assessment of a proposed regulation's costs, benefits and alternatives before it is finalised, and it remains unevenly institutionalised across Indian ministries and regulators, so it must be cited as an emerging good-governance practice rather than as a uniformly binding legal requirement.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Pre-Legislative Consultation Policy of 2014 advises Union departments to publish draft legislation with an explanatory note and an ordinary minimum public comment window of about thirty days before introduction, and it is an executive policy rather than a statute whose comments are not binding, so publishing a draft is consultation compliance while incorporating feedback is consultation depth. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q30. Which chronology card should be filed under The Pre-Legislative Consultation Policy of 2014?

A. Coverage under the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 is authority-based rather than subject-matter-based or territorial, so a state board or university examination is not automatically covered merely because the Act extends to India, and inclusion requires either notification of that authority by the Central Government or separate state legislation, which is precisely the scope half of the 2024 demand and the point an aims-only answer misses. B. The Pre-Legislative Consultation Policy of 2014 advises Union departments to publish draft legislation with an explanatory note and an ordinary minimum public comment window of about thirty days before introduction, and it is an executive policy rather than a statute whose comments are not binding, so publishing a draft is consultation compliance while incorporating feedback is consultation depth. C. Convergence is the deliberate alignment of multiple schemes and departments toward a common local outcome, and its analytical value is that it adds no new scheme but removes clearance points and duplicate targeting between existing ones at the district and panchayat level, which is why it improves outcomes without a proportional increase in outlay and why it fails wherever functional devolution is absent. D. The Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 was enacted to prevent and penalise unfair means such as question-paper leaks, impersonation and tampering in public examinations, it came into force on 21 June 2024 by notification S.O. 2422(E), and its scheduled central authorities include the Union Public Service Commission, the Staff Selection Commission, Railway Recruitment Boards, the Institute of Banking Personnel Selection, Central Government departments and attached offices, and the National Testing Agency.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Pre-Legislative Consultation Policy of 2014 advises Union departments to publish draft legislation with an explanatory note and an ordinary minimum public comment window of about thirty days before introduction, and it is an executive policy rather than a statute whose comments are not binding, so publishing a draft is consultation compliance while incorporating feedback is consultation depth. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q31. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The Pre-Legislative Consultation Policy of 2014?

A. The Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 was enacted to prevent and penalise unfair means such as question-paper leaks, impersonation and tampering in public examinations, it came into force on 21 June 2024 by notification S.O. 2422(E), and its scheduled central authorities include the Union Public Service Commission, the Staff Selection Commission, Railway Recruitment Boards, the Institute of Banking Personnel Selection, Central Government departments and attached offices, and the National Testing Agency. B. Any unfamiliar policy can be diagnosed through six stages - legal authority and who is bound, rules and standard operating procedures specifying entitlement and eligibility, the named responsible agency across Union, state, district, local or parastatal levels, staff and money and technology including sanctioned against filled posts and the fund-flow route, the citizen interface of awareness and documents and distance and language and digital access, and grievance and review including appeal, penalty, evaluation and any sunset clause - and an enacted law can stall at any stage after the first. C. The Pre-Legislative Consultation Policy of 2014 advises Union departments to publish draft legislation with an explanatory note and an ordinary minimum public comment window of about thirty days before introduction, and it is an executive policy rather than a statute whose comments are not binding, so publishing a draft is consultation compliance while incorporating feedback is consultation depth. D. Coverage under the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 is authority-based rather than subject-matter-based or territorial, so a state board or university examination is not automatically covered merely because the Act extends to India, and inclusion requires either notification of that authority by the Central Government or separate state legislation, which is precisely the scope half of the 2024 demand and the point an aims-only answer misses.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Pre-Legislative Consultation Policy of 2014 advises Union departments to publish draft legislation with an explanatory note and an ordinary minimum public comment window of about thirty days before introduction, and it is an executive policy rather than a statute whose comments are not binding, so publishing a draft is consultation compliance while incorporating feedback is consultation depth. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q32. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The Pre-Legislative Consultation Policy of 2014?

A. Coverage under the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 is authority-based rather than subject-matter-based or territorial, so a state board or university examination is not automatically covered merely because the Act extends to India, and inclusion requires either notification of that authority by the Central Government or separate state legislation, which is precisely the scope half of the 2024 demand and the point an aims-only answer misses. B. Any unfamiliar policy can be diagnosed through six stages - legal authority and who is bound, rules and standard operating procedures specifying entitlement and eligibility, the named responsible agency across Union, state, district, local or parastatal levels, staff and money and technology including sanctioned against filled posts and the fund-flow route, the citizen interface of awareness and documents and distance and language and digital access, and grievance and review including appeal, penalty, evaluation and any sunset clause - and an enacted law can stall at any stage after the first. C. The Aspirational Districts Programme of NITI Aayog targets inter-district rather than inter-state divergence across 112 districts using 49 key performance indicators grouped into five themes - health and nutrition, education, agriculture and water resources, financial inclusion and skill development, and basic infrastructure - tracked on the Champions of Change dashboard, and it operates through the three named levers of convergence, collaboration including the Prabhari officer arrangement, and competition through delta ranking. D. The Pre-Legislative Consultation Policy of 2014 advises Union departments to publish draft legislation with an explanatory note and an ordinary minimum public comment window of about thirty days before introduction, and it is an executive policy rather than a statute whose comments are not binding, so publishing a draft is consultation compliance while incorporating feedback is consultation depth.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Pre-Legislative Consultation Policy of 2014 advises Union departments to publish draft legislation with an explanatory note and an ordinary minimum public comment window of about thirty days before introduction, and it is an executive policy rather than a statute whose comments are not binding, so publishing a draft is consultation compliance while incorporating feedback is consultation depth. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q33. Which statement correctly identifies Regulatory impact assessment as an emerging practice?

A. A regulatory impact assessment is a structured ex-ante assessment of a proposed regulation's costs, benefits and alternatives before it is finalised, and it remains unevenly institutionalised across Indian ministries and regulators, so it must be cited as an emerging good-governance practice rather than as a uniformly binding legal requirement. B. The Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 was enacted to prevent and penalise unfair means such as question-paper leaks, impersonation and tampering in public examinations, it came into force on 21 June 2024 by notification S.O. 2422(E), and its scheduled central authorities include the Union Public Service Commission, the Staff Selection Commission, Railway Recruitment Boards, the Institute of Banking Personnel Selection, Central Government departments and attached offices, and the National Testing Agency. C. Coverage under the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 is authority-based rather than subject-matter-based or territorial, so a state board or university examination is not automatically covered merely because the Act extends to India, and inclusion requires either notification of that authority by the Central Government or separate state legislation, which is precisely the scope half of the 2024 demand and the point an aims-only answer misses. D. Convergence is the deliberate alignment of multiple schemes and departments toward a common local outcome, and its analytical value is that it adds no new scheme but removes clearance points and duplicate targeting between existing ones at the district and panchayat level, which is why it improves outcomes without a proportional increase in outlay and why it fails wherever functional devolution is absent.

Answer: A. Explanation: A regulatory impact assessment is a structured ex-ante assessment of a proposed regulation's costs, benefits and alternatives before it is finalised, and it remains unevenly institutionalised across Indian ministries and regulators, so it must be cited as an emerging good-governance practice rather than as a uniformly binding legal requirement. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q34. Which chronology card should be filed under Regulatory impact assessment as an emerging practice?

A. The Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 was enacted to prevent and penalise unfair means such as question-paper leaks, impersonation and tampering in public examinations, it came into force on 21 June 2024 by notification S.O. 2422(E), and its scheduled central authorities include the Union Public Service Commission, the Staff Selection Commission, Railway Recruitment Boards, the Institute of Banking Personnel Selection, Central Government departments and attached offices, and the National Testing Agency. B. A regulatory impact assessment is a structured ex-ante assessment of a proposed regulation's costs, benefits and alternatives before it is finalised, and it remains unevenly institutionalised across Indian ministries and regulators, so it must be cited as an emerging good-governance practice rather than as a uniformly binding legal requirement. C. Coverage under the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 is authority-based rather than subject-matter-based or territorial, so a state board or university examination is not automatically covered merely because the Act extends to India, and inclusion requires either notification of that authority by the Central Government or separate state legislation, which is precisely the scope half of the 2024 demand and the point an aims-only answer misses. D. Any unfamiliar policy can be diagnosed through six stages - legal authority and who is bound, rules and standard operating procedures specifying entitlement and eligibility, the named responsible agency across Union, state, district, local or parastatal levels, staff and money and technology including sanctioned against filled posts and the fund-flow route, the citizen interface of awareness and documents and distance and language and digital access, and grievance and review including appeal, penalty, evaluation and any sunset clause - and an enacted law can stall at any stage after the first.

Answer: B. Explanation: A regulatory impact assessment is a structured ex-ante assessment of a proposed regulation's costs, benefits and alternatives before it is finalised, and it remains unevenly institutionalised across Indian ministries and regulators, so it must be cited as an emerging good-governance practice rather than as a uniformly binding legal requirement. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q35. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Regulatory impact assessment as an emerging practice?

A. Coverage under the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 is authority-based rather than subject-matter-based or territorial, so a state board or university examination is not automatically covered merely because the Act extends to India, and inclusion requires either notification of that authority by the Central Government or separate state legislation, which is precisely the scope half of the 2024 demand and the point an aims-only answer misses. B. Any unfamiliar policy can be diagnosed through six stages - legal authority and who is bound, rules and standard operating procedures specifying entitlement and eligibility, the named responsible agency across Union, state, district, local or parastatal levels, staff and money and technology including sanctioned against filled posts and the fund-flow route, the citizen interface of awareness and documents and distance and language and digital access, and grievance and review including appeal, penalty, evaluation and any sunset clause - and an enacted law can stall at any stage after the first. C. A regulatory impact assessment is a structured ex-ante assessment of a proposed regulation's costs, benefits and alternatives before it is finalised, and it remains unevenly institutionalised across Indian ministries and regulators, so it must be cited as an emerging good-governance practice rather than as a uniformly binding legal requirement. D. The Aspirational Districts Programme of NITI Aayog targets inter-district rather than inter-state divergence across 112 districts using 49 key performance indicators grouped into five themes - health and nutrition, education, agriculture and water resources, financial inclusion and skill development, and basic infrastructure - tracked on the Champions of Change dashboard, and it operates through the three named levers of convergence, collaboration including the Prabhari officer arrangement, and competition through delta ranking.

Answer: C. Explanation: A regulatory impact assessment is a structured ex-ante assessment of a proposed regulation's costs, benefits and alternatives before it is finalised, and it remains unevenly institutionalised across Indian ministries and regulators, so it must be cited as an emerging good-governance practice rather than as a uniformly binding legal requirement. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q36. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Regulatory impact assessment as an emerging practice?

A. Delta ranking scores the pace of improvement rather than the absolute level so that the historically worst-off district is not permanently bottom and therefore permanently unmotivated, while the dashboard data is largely district-self-reported with validation by selected agencies and the district unit can mask intra-district divergence, which is why the Aspirational Blocks Programme covering 513 blocks exists as a separate and non-substitutable unit and why the programme is best read as an administrative-attention and convergence instrument rather than a financing instrument. B. The Aspirational Districts Programme of NITI Aayog targets inter-district rather than inter-state divergence across 112 districts using 49 key performance indicators grouped into five themes - health and nutrition, education, agriculture and water resources, financial inclusion and skill development, and basic infrastructure - tracked on the Champions of Change dashboard, and it operates through the three named levers of convergence, collaboration including the Prabhari officer arrangement, and competition through delta ranking. C. Any unfamiliar policy can be diagnosed through six stages - legal authority and who is bound, rules and standard operating procedures specifying entitlement and eligibility, the named responsible agency across Union, state, district, local or parastatal levels, staff and money and technology including sanctioned against filled posts and the fund-flow route, the citizen interface of awareness and documents and distance and language and digital access, and grievance and review including appeal, penalty, evaluation and any sunset clause - and an enacted law can stall at any stage after the first. D. A regulatory impact assessment is a structured ex-ante assessment of a proposed regulation's costs, benefits and alternatives before it is finalised, and it remains unevenly institutionalised across Indian ministries and regulators, so it must be cited as an emerging good-governance practice rather than as a uniformly binding legal requirement.

Answer: D. Explanation: A regulatory impact assessment is a structured ex-ante assessment of a proposed regulation's costs, benefits and alternatives before it is finalised, and it remains unevenly institutionalised across Indian ministries and regulators, so it must be cited as an emerging good-governance practice rather than as a uniformly binding legal requirement. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q37. Which statement correctly identifies Convergence as clearance-point removal?

A. Convergence is the deliberate alignment of multiple schemes and departments toward a common local outcome, and its analytical value is that it adds no new scheme but removes clearance points and duplicate targeting between existing ones at the district and panchayat level, which is why it improves outcomes without a proportional increase in outlay and why it fails wherever functional devolution is absent. B. Coverage under the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 is authority-based rather than subject-matter-based or territorial, so a state board or university examination is not automatically covered merely because the Act extends to India, and inclusion requires either notification of that authority by the Central Government or separate state legislation, which is precisely the scope half of the 2024 demand and the point an aims-only answer misses. C. Any unfamiliar policy can be diagnosed through six stages - legal authority and who is bound, rules and standard operating procedures specifying entitlement and eligibility, the named responsible agency across Union, state, district, local or parastatal levels, staff and money and technology including sanctioned against filled posts and the fund-flow route, the citizen interface of awareness and documents and distance and language and digital access, and grievance and review including appeal, penalty, evaluation and any sunset clause - and an enacted law can stall at any stage after the first. D. The Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 was enacted to prevent and penalise unfair means such as question-paper leaks, impersonation and tampering in public examinations, it came into force on 21 June 2024 by notification S.O. 2422(E), and its scheduled central authorities include the Union Public Service Commission, the Staff Selection Commission, Railway Recruitment Boards, the Institute of Banking Personnel Selection, Central Government departments and attached offices, and the National Testing Agency.

Answer: A. Explanation: Convergence is the deliberate alignment of multiple schemes and departments toward a common local outcome, and its analytical value is that it adds no new scheme but removes clearance points and duplicate targeting between existing ones at the district and panchayat level, which is why it improves outcomes without a proportional increase in outlay and why it fails wherever functional devolution is absent. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q38. Which chronology card should be filed under Convergence as clearance-point removal?

A. Any unfamiliar policy can be diagnosed through six stages - legal authority and who is bound, rules and standard operating procedures specifying entitlement and eligibility, the named responsible agency across Union, state, district, local or parastatal levels, staff and money and technology including sanctioned against filled posts and the fund-flow route, the citizen interface of awareness and documents and distance and language and digital access, and grievance and review including appeal, penalty, evaluation and any sunset clause - and an enacted law can stall at any stage after the first. B. Convergence is the deliberate alignment of multiple schemes and departments toward a common local outcome, and its analytical value is that it adds no new scheme but removes clearance points and duplicate targeting between existing ones at the district and panchayat level, which is why it improves outcomes without a proportional increase in outlay and why it fails wherever functional devolution is absent. C. The Aspirational Districts Programme of NITI Aayog targets inter-district rather than inter-state divergence across 112 districts using 49 key performance indicators grouped into five themes - health and nutrition, education, agriculture and water resources, financial inclusion and skill development, and basic infrastructure - tracked on the Champions of Change dashboard, and it operates through the three named levers of convergence, collaboration including the Prabhari officer arrangement, and competition through delta ranking. D. Coverage under the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 is authority-based rather than subject-matter-based or territorial, so a state board or university examination is not automatically covered merely because the Act extends to India, and inclusion requires either notification of that authority by the Central Government or separate state legislation, which is precisely the scope half of the 2024 demand and the point an aims-only answer misses.

Answer: B. Explanation: Convergence is the deliberate alignment of multiple schemes and departments toward a common local outcome, and its analytical value is that it adds no new scheme but removes clearance points and duplicate targeting between existing ones at the district and panchayat level, which is why it improves outcomes without a proportional increase in outlay and why it fails wherever functional devolution is absent. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q39. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Convergence as clearance-point removal?

A. Any unfamiliar policy can be diagnosed through six stages - legal authority and who is bound, rules and standard operating procedures specifying entitlement and eligibility, the named responsible agency across Union, state, district, local or parastatal levels, staff and money and technology including sanctioned against filled posts and the fund-flow route, the citizen interface of awareness and documents and distance and language and digital access, and grievance and review including appeal, penalty, evaluation and any sunset clause - and an enacted law can stall at any stage after the first. B. Delta ranking scores the pace of improvement rather than the absolute level so that the historically worst-off district is not permanently bottom and therefore permanently unmotivated, while the dashboard data is largely district-self-reported with validation by selected agencies and the district unit can mask intra-district divergence, which is why the Aspirational Blocks Programme covering 513 blocks exists as a separate and non-substitutable unit and why the programme is best read as an administrative-attention and convergence instrument rather than a financing instrument. C. Convergence is the deliberate alignment of multiple schemes and departments toward a common local outcome, and its analytical value is that it adds no new scheme but removes clearance points and duplicate targeting between existing ones at the district and panchayat level, which is why it improves outcomes without a proportional increase in outlay and why it fails wherever functional devolution is absent. D. The Aspirational Districts Programme of NITI Aayog targets inter-district rather than inter-state divergence across 112 districts using 49 key performance indicators grouped into five themes - health and nutrition, education, agriculture and water resources, financial inclusion and skill development, and basic infrastructure - tracked on the Champions of Change dashboard, and it operates through the three named levers of convergence, collaboration including the Prabhari officer arrangement, and competition through delta ranking.

Answer: C. Explanation: Convergence is the deliberate alignment of multiple schemes and departments toward a common local outcome, and its analytical value is that it adds no new scheme but removes clearance points and duplicate targeting between existing ones at the district and panchayat level, which is why it improves outcomes without a proportional increase in outlay and why it fails wherever functional devolution is absent. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q40. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Convergence as clearance-point removal?

A. Delta ranking scores the pace of improvement rather than the absolute level so that the historically worst-off district is not permanently bottom and therefore permanently unmotivated, while the dashboard data is largely district-self-reported with validation by selected agencies and the district unit can mask intra-district divergence, which is why the Aspirational Blocks Programme covering 513 blocks exists as a separate and non-substitutable unit and why the programme is best read as an administrative-attention and convergence instrument rather than a financing instrument. B. Environmental degradation is frequently produced not by an absence of policy but by mutually contradicting policies pursued by different ministries with separate mandates and no arbitration mechanism, because each sectoral ministry optimises its own objective function, no single actor is accountable for the aggregate outcome, and the environmental cost is an externality that appears in nobody's departmental performance metric - although some contradictions are genuine value conflicts between livelihood today and ecological stock tomorrow rather than coordination failures. C. The Aspirational Districts Programme of NITI Aayog targets inter-district rather than inter-state divergence across 112 districts using 49 key performance indicators grouped into five themes - health and nutrition, education, agriculture and water resources, financial inclusion and skill development, and basic infrastructure - tracked on the Champions of Change dashboard, and it operates through the three named levers of convergence, collaboration including the Prabhari officer arrangement, and competition through delta ranking. D. Convergence is the deliberate alignment of multiple schemes and departments toward a common local outcome, and its analytical value is that it adds no new scheme but removes clearance points and duplicate targeting between existing ones at the district and panchayat level, which is why it improves outcomes without a proportional increase in outlay and why it fails wherever functional devolution is absent.

Answer: D. Explanation: Convergence is the deliberate alignment of multiple schemes and departments toward a common local outcome, and its analytical value is that it adds no new scheme but removes clearance points and duplicate targeting between existing ones at the district and panchayat level, which is why it improves outcomes without a proportional increase in outlay and why it fails wherever functional

devolution is absent. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q41. Which statement correctly identifies The Public Examinations Act, 2024 and its commencement?

A. The Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 was enacted to prevent and penalise unfair means such as question-paper leaks, impersonation and tampering in public examinations, it came into force on 21 June 2024 by notification S.O. 2422(E), and its scheduled central authorities include the Union Public Service Commission, the Staff Selection Commission, Railway Recruitment Boards, the Institute of Banking Personnel Selection, Central Government departments and attached offices, and the National Testing Agency. B. Coverage under the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 is authority-based rather than subject-matter-based or territorial, so a state board or university examination is not automatically covered merely because the Act extends to India, and inclusion requires either notification of that authority by the Central Government or separate state legislation, which is precisely the scope half of the 2024 demand and the point an aims-only answer misses. C. Any unfamiliar policy can be diagnosed through six stages - legal authority and who is bound, rules and standard operating procedures specifying entitlement and eligibility, the named responsible agency across Union, state, district, local or parastatal levels, staff and money and technology including sanctioned against filled posts and the fund-flow route, the citizen interface of awareness and documents and distance and language and digital access, and grievance and review including appeal, penalty, evaluation and any sunset clause - and an enacted law can stall at any stage after the first. D. The Aspirational Districts Programme of NITI Aayog targets inter-district rather than inter-state divergence across 112 districts using 49 key performance indicators grouped into five themes - health and nutrition, education, agriculture and water resources, financial inclusion and skill development, and basic infrastructure - tracked on the Champions of Change dashboard, and it operates through the three named levers of convergence, collaboration including the Prabhari officer arrangement, and competition through delta ranking.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 was enacted to prevent and penalise unfair means such as question-paper leaks, impersonation and tampering in public examinations, it came into force on 21 June 2024 by notification S.O. 2422(E), and its scheduled central authorities include the Union Public Service Commission, the Staff Selection Commission, Railway Recruitment Boards, the Institute of Banking Personnel Selection, Central Government departments and attached offices, and the National Testing Agency. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q42. Which chronology card should be filed under The Public Examinations Act, 2024 and its commencement?

A. Any unfamiliar policy can be diagnosed through six stages - legal authority and who is bound, rules and standard operating procedures specifying entitlement and eligibility, the named responsible agency across Union, state, district, local or parastatal levels, staff and money and technology including sanctioned against filled posts and the fund-flow route, the citizen interface of awareness and documents and distance and language and digital access, and grievance and review including appeal, penalty, evaluation and any sunset clause - and an enacted law can stall at any stage after the first. B. The Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 was enacted to prevent and penalise unfair means such as question-paper leaks, impersonation and tampering in public examinations, it came into force on 21 June 2024 by notification S.O. 2422(E), and its scheduled central authorities include the Union Public Service Commission, the Staff Selection Commission, Railway Recruitment Boards, the Institute of Banking Personnel Selection, Central Government departments and attached offices, and the National Testing Agency. C. Delta ranking scores the pace of improvement rather than the absolute level so that the historically worst-off district is not permanently bottom and therefore permanently unmotivated, while the dashboard data is largely district-self-reported with validation by selected agencies and the district unit can mask intra-district divergence, which is why the Aspirational Blocks Programme covering 513 blocks exists as a separate and non-substitutable unit and why the programme is best read as an administrative-attention and convergence instrument rather than a financing instrument. D. The Aspirational Districts Programme of NITI Aayog targets inter-district rather than inter-state divergence across 112 districts using 49 key performance indicators grouped into five themes - health and nutrition, education, agriculture and water resources, financial inclusion and skill development, and basic infrastructure - tracked on the Champions of Change dashboard, and it operates through the three named levers of convergence, collaboration including the Prabhari officer arrangement, and competition through delta ranking.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 was enacted to prevent and penalise unfair means such as question-paper leaks, impersonation and tampering in public examinations, it came into force on 21 June 2024 by notification S.O. 2422(E), and its scheduled central authorities include the Union Public Service Commission, the Staff Selection Commission, Railway Recruitment Boards, the Institute of Banking Personnel Selection, Central Government departments and attached offices, and the National Testing Agency. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q43. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The Public Examinations Act, 2024 and its commencement?

A. Delta ranking scores the pace of improvement rather than the absolute level so that the historically worst-off district is not permanently bottom and therefore permanently unmotivated, while the dashboard data is largely district-self-reported with validation by selected agencies and the district unit can mask intra-district divergence, which is why the Aspirational Blocks Programme covering 513 blocks exists as a separate and non-substitutable unit and why the programme is best read as an administrative-attention and convergence instrument rather than a financing instrument. B. The Aspirational Districts Programme of NITI Aayog targets inter-district rather than inter-state divergence across 112 districts using 49 key performance indicators grouped into five themes - health and nutrition, education, agriculture and water resources, financial inclusion and skill development, and basic infrastructure - tracked on the Champions of Change dashboard, and it operates through the three named levers of convergence, collaboration including the Prabhari officer arrangement, and competition through delta ranking. C. The Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 was enacted to prevent and penalise unfair means such as question-paper leaks, impersonation and tampering in public examinations, it came into force on 21 June 2024 by notification S.O. 2422(E), and its scheduled central authorities include the Union Public Service Commission, the Staff Selection Commission, Railway Recruitment Boards, the Institute of Banking Personnel Selection, Central Government departments and attached offices, and the National Testing Agency. D. Environmental degradation is frequently produced not by an absence of policy but by mutually contradicting policies pursued by different ministries with separate mandates and no arbitration mechanism, because each sectoral ministry optimises its own objective function, no single actor is accountable for the aggregate outcome, and the environmental cost is an externality that appears in nobody's departmental performance metric - although some contradictions are genuine value conflicts between livelihood today and ecological stock tomorrow rather than coordination failures.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 was enacted to prevent and penalise unfair means such as question-paper leaks, impersonation and tampering in public examinations, it came into force on 21 June 2024 by notification S.O. 2422(E), and its scheduled central authorities include the Union Public Service Commission, the Staff Selection Commission, Railway Recruitment Boards, the Institute of Banking Personnel Selection, Central Government departments and attached offices, and the National Testing Agency. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q44. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The Public Examinations Act, 2024 and its commencement?

A. Delta ranking scores the pace of improvement rather than the absolute level so that the historically worst-off district is not permanently bottom and therefore permanently unmotivated, while the dashboard data is largely district-self-reported with validation by selected agencies and the district unit can mask intra-district divergence, which is why the Aspirational Blocks Programme covering 513 blocks exists as a separate and non-substitutable unit and why the programme is best read as an administrative-attention and convergence instrument rather than a financing instrument. B. Environmental degradation is frequently produced not by an absence of policy but by mutually contradicting policies pursued by different ministries with separate mandates and no arbitration mechanism, because each sectoral ministry optimises its own objective function, no single actor is accountable for the aggregate outcome, and the environmental cost is an externality that appears in nobody's departmental performance metric - although some contradictions are genuine value conflicts between livelihood today and ecological stock tomorrow rather than coordination failures. C. PM GatiShakti is a National Master Plan approach for multi-modal infrastructure connectivity built on a shared geographic-information-system planning platform that layers infrastructure and utility data from multiple ministries, and its mechanism is the removal of sequencing failure and private-sector information risk through

a common map, but it coordinates information rather than authority, since land, utilities and many approvals remain with states and local bodies. D. The Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 was enacted to prevent and penalise unfair means such as question-paper leaks, impersonation and tampering in public examinations, it came into force on 21 June 2024 by notification S.O. 2422(E), and its scheduled central authorities include the Union Public Service Commission, the Staff Selection Commission, Railway Recruitment Boards, the Institute of Banking Personnel Selection, Central Government departments and attached offices, and the National Testing Agency.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 was enacted to prevent and penalise unfair means such as question-paper leaks, impersonation and tampering in public examinations, it came into force on 21 June 2024 by notification S.O. 2422(E), and its scheduled central authorities include the Union Public Service Commission, the Staff Selection Commission, Railway Recruitment Boards, the Institute of Banking Personnel Selection, Central Government departments and attached offices, and the National Testing Agency. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q45. Which statement correctly identifies Authority-based coverage against territorial extent?

A. Coverage under the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 is authority-based rather than subject-matter-based or territorial, so a state board or university examination is not automatically covered merely because the Act extends to India, and inclusion requires either notification of that authority by the Central Government or separate state legislation, which is precisely the scope half of the 2024 demand and the point an aims-only answer misses. B. Delta ranking scores the pace of improvement rather than the absolute level so that the historically worst-off district is not permanently bottom and therefore permanently unmotivated, while the dashboard data is largely district-self-reported with validation by selected agencies and the district unit can mask intra-district divergence, which is why the Aspirational Blocks Programme covering 513 blocks exists as a separate and non-substitutable unit and why the programme is best read as an administrative-attention and convergence instrument rather than a financing instrument. C. Any unfamiliar policy can be diagnosed through six stages - legal authority and who is bound, rules and standard operating procedures specifying entitlement and eligibility, the named responsible agency across Union, state, district, local or parastatal levels, staff and money and technology including sanctioned against filled posts and the fund-flow route, the citizen interface of awareness and documents and distance and language and digital access, and grievance and review including appeal, penalty, evaluation and any sunset clause - and an enacted law can stall at any stage after the first. D. The Aspirational Districts Programme of NITI Aayog targets inter-district rather than inter-state divergence across 112 districts using 49 key performance indicators grouped into five themes - health and nutrition, education, agriculture and water resources, financial inclusion and skill development, and basic infrastructure - tracked on the Champions of Change dashboard, and it operates through the three named levers of convergence, collaboration including the Prabhari officer arrangement, and competition through delta ranking.

Answer: A. Explanation: Coverage under the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 is authority-based rather than subject-matter-based or territorial, so a state board or university examination is not automatically covered merely because the Act extends to India, and inclusion requires either notification of that authority by the Central Government or separate state legislation, which is precisely the scope half of the 2024 demand and the point an aims-only answer misses. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q46. Which chronology card should be filed under Authority-based coverage against territorial extent?

A. The Aspirational Districts Programme of NITI Aayog targets inter-district rather than inter-state divergence across 112 districts using 49 key performance indicators grouped into five themes - health and nutrition, education, agriculture and water resources, financial inclusion and skill development, and basic infrastructure - tracked on the Champions of Change dashboard, and it operates through the three named levers of convergence, collaboration including the Prabhari officer arrangement, and competition through delta ranking. B. Coverage under the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 is authority-based rather than subject-matter-based or territorial, so a state board or university examination is not automatically covered merely because the Act extends to India, and inclusion requires either notification of that authority by the Central Government or separate state legislation, which is

precisely the scope half of the 2024 demand and the point an aims-only answer misses. C. Environmental degradation is frequently produced not by an absence of policy but by mutually contradicting policies pursued by different ministries with separate mandates and no arbitration mechanism, because each sectoral ministry optimises its own objective function, no single actor is accountable for the aggregate outcome, and the environmental cost is an externality that appears in nobody's departmental performance metric - although some contradictions are genuine value conflicts between livelihood today and ecological stock tomorrow rather than coordination failures. D. Delta ranking scores the pace of improvement rather than the absolute level so that the historically worst-off district is not permanently bottom and therefore permanently unmotivated, while the dashboard data is largely district-self-reported with validation by selected agencies and the district unit can mask intra-district divergence, which is why the Aspirational Blocks Programme covering 513 blocks exists as a separate and non-substitutable unit and why the programme is best read as an administrative-attention and convergence instrument rather than a financing instrument.

Answer: B. Explanation: Coverage under the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 is authority-based rather than subject-matter-based or territorial, so a state board or university examination is not automatically covered merely because the Act extends to India, and inclusion requires either notification of that authority by the Central Government or separate state legislation, which is precisely the scope half of the 2024 demand and the point an aims-only answer misses. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q47. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Authority-based coverage against territorial extent?

A. Environmental degradation is frequently produced not by an absence of policy but by mutually contradicting policies pursued by different ministries with separate mandates and no arbitration mechanism, because each sectoral ministry optimises its own objective function, no single actor is accountable for the aggregate outcome, and the environmental cost is an externality that appears in nobody's departmental performance metric - although some contradictions are genuine value conflicts between livelihood today and ecological stock tomorrow rather than coordination failures. B. PM GatiShakti is a National Master Plan approach for multi-modal infrastructure connectivity built on a shared geographic-information-system planning platform that layers infrastructure and utility data from multiple ministries, and its mechanism is the removal of sequencing failure and private-sector information risk through a common map, but it coordinates information rather than authority, since land, utilities and many approvals remain with states and local bodies. C. Coverage under the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 is authority-based rather than subject-matter-based or territorial, so a state board or university examination is not automatically covered merely because the Act extends to India, and inclusion requires either notification of that authority by the Central Government or separate state legislation, which is precisely the scope half of the 2024 demand and the point an aims-only answer misses. D. Delta ranking scores the pace of improvement rather than the absolute level so that the historically worst-off district is not permanently bottom and therefore permanently unmotivated, while the dashboard data is largely district-self-reported with validation by selected agencies and the district unit can mask intra-district divergence, which is why the Aspirational Blocks Programme covering 513 blocks exists as a separate and non-substitutable unit and why the programme is best read as an administrative-attention and convergence instrument rather than a financing instrument.

Answer: C. Explanation: Coverage under the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 is authority-based rather than subject-matter-based or territorial, so a state board or university examination is not automatically covered merely because the Act extends to India, and inclusion requires either notification of that authority by the Central Government or separate state legislation, which is precisely the scope half of the 2024 demand and the point an aims-only answer misses. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q48. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Authority-based coverage against territorial extent?

A. A public-private partnership is a procurement and service-delivery choice rather than privatisation by definition, and its governance chain runs from public purpose and output standard through risk allocation to the actor best able to manage each risk, competitive procurement with disclosed criteria, performance-linked payment, independent monitoring and contract disclosure, renegotiation and exit rules, to affordability and continuity safeguards, with Viability Gap Funding supporting economically justified but commercially weak projects and the Hybrid Annuity Model illustrating deliberate risk-sharing. B. PM GatiShakti is a National Master Plan approach for multi-modal infrastructure connectivity built on a shared geographic-information-system planning platform that layers infrastructure and utility data from multiple ministries, and its mechanism is the removal of sequencing failure and private-sector information risk through a common map, but it coordinates information rather than authority, since land, utilities and many approvals remain with states and local bodies. C. Environmental degradation is frequently produced not by an absence of policy but by mutually contradicting policies pursued by different ministries with separate mandates and no arbitration mechanism, because each sectoral ministry optimises its own objective function, no single actor is accountable for the aggregate outcome, and the environmental cost is an externality that appears in nobody's departmental performance metric - although some contradictions are genuine value conflicts between livelihood today and ecological stock tomorrow rather than coordination failures. D. Coverage under the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 is authority-based rather than subject-matter-based or territorial, so a state board or university examination is not automatically covered merely because the Act extends to India, and inclusion requires either notification of that authority by the Central Government or separate state legislation, which is precisely the scope half of the 2024 demand and the point an aims-only answer misses.

Answer: D. Explanation: Coverage under the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 is authority-based rather than subject-matter-based or territorial, so a state board or university examination is not automatically covered merely because the Act extends to India, and inclusion requires either notification of that authority by the Central Government or separate state legislation, which is precisely the scope half of the 2024 demand and the point an aims-only answer misses. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q49. Which statement correctly identifies The six-stage implementation map?

A. Any unfamiliar policy can be diagnosed through six stages - legal authority and who is bound, rules and standard operating procedures specifying entitlement and eligibility, the named responsible agency across Union, state, district, local or parastatal levels, staff and money and technology including sanctioned against filled posts and the fund-flow route, the citizen interface of awareness and documents and distance and language and digital access, and grievance and review including appeal, penalty, evaluation and any sunset clause - and an enacted law can stall at any stage after the first. B. Delta ranking scores the pace of improvement rather than the absolute level so that the historically worst-off district is not permanently bottom and therefore permanently unmotivated, while the dashboard data is largely district-self-reported with validation by selected agencies and the district unit can mask intra-district divergence, which is why the Aspirational Blocks Programme covering 513 blocks exists as a separate and non-substitutable unit and why the programme is best read as an administrative-attention and convergence instrument rather than a financing instrument. C. The Aspirational Districts Programme of NITI Aayog targets inter-district rather than inter-state divergence across 112 districts using 49 key performance indicators grouped into five themes - health and nutrition, education, agriculture and water resources, financial inclusion and skill development, and basic infrastructure - tracked on the Champions of Change dashboard, and it operates through the three named levers of convergence, collaboration including the Prabhari officer arrangement, and competition through delta ranking. D. Environmental degradation is frequently produced not by an absence of policy but by mutually contradicting policies pursued by different ministries with separate mandates and no arbitration mechanism, because each sectoral ministry optimises its own objective function, no single actor is accountable for the aggregate outcome, and the environmental cost is an externality that appears in nobody's departmental performance metric - although some contradictions are genuine value conflicts between livelihood today and ecological stock tomorrow rather than coordination failures.

Answer: A. Explanation: Any unfamiliar policy can be diagnosed through six stages - legal authority and who is bound, rules and standard operating procedures specifying entitlement and eligibility, the named responsible agency across Union, state, district, local or parastatal levels, staff and money and technology

including sanctioned against filled posts and the fund-flow route, the citizen interface of awareness and documents and distance and language and digital access, and grievance and review including appeal, penalty, evaluation and any sunset clause - and an enacted law can stall at any stage after the first. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q50. Which chronology card should be filed under The six-stage implementation map?

A. Delta ranking scores the pace of improvement rather than the absolute level so that the historically worst-off district is not permanently bottom and therefore permanently unmotivated, while the dashboard data is largely district-self-reported with validation by selected agencies and the district unit can mask intra-district divergence, which is why the Aspirational Blocks Programme covering 513 blocks exists as a separate and non-substitutable unit and why the programme is best read as an administrative-attention and convergence instrument rather than a financing instrument. B. Any unfamiliar policy can be diagnosed through six stages - legal authority and who is bound, rules and standard operating procedures specifying entitlement and eligibility, the named responsible agency across Union, state, district, local or parastatal levels, staff and money and technology including sanctioned against filled posts and the fund-flow route, the citizen interface of awareness and documents and distance and language and digital access, and grievance and review including appeal, penalty, evaluation and any sunset clause - and an enacted law can stall at any stage after the first. C. PM GatiShakti is a National Master Plan approach for multi-modal infrastructure connectivity built on a shared geographic-information-system planning platform that layers infrastructure and utility data from multiple ministries, and its mechanism is the removal of sequencing failure and private-sector information risk through a common map, but it coordinates information rather than authority, since land, utilities and many approvals remain with states and local bodies. D. Environmental degradation is frequently produced not by an absence of policy but by mutually contradicting policies pursued by different ministries with separate mandates and no arbitration mechanism, because each sectoral ministry optimises its own objective function, no single actor is accountable for the aggregate outcome, and the environmental cost is an externality that appears in nobody's departmental performance metric - although some contradictions are genuine value conflicts between livelihood today and ecological stock tomorrow rather than coordination failures.

Answer: B. Explanation: Any unfamiliar policy can be diagnosed through six stages - legal authority and who is bound, rules and standard operating procedures specifying entitlement and eligibility, the named responsible agency across Union, state, district, local or parastatal levels, staff and money and technology including sanctioned against filled posts and the fund-flow route, the citizen interface of awareness and documents and distance and language and digital access, and grievance and review including appeal, penalty, evaluation and any sunset clause - and an enacted law can stall at any stage after the first. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q51. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The six-stage implementation map?

A. PM GatiShakti is a National Master Plan approach for multi-modal infrastructure connectivity built on a shared geographic-information-system planning platform that layers infrastructure and utility data from multiple ministries, and its mechanism is the removal of sequencing failure and private-sector information risk through a common map, but it coordinates information rather than authority, since land, utilities and many approvals remain with states and local bodies. B. A public-private partnership is a procurement and service-delivery choice rather than privatisation by definition, and its governance chain runs from public purpose and output standard through risk allocation to the actor best able to manage each risk, competitive procurement with disclosed criteria, performance-linked payment, independent monitoring and contract disclosure, renegotiation and exit rules, to affordability and continuity safeguards, with Viability Gap Funding supporting economically justified but commercially weak projects and the Hybrid Annuity Model illustrating deliberate risk-sharing. C. Any unfamiliar policy can be diagnosed through six stages - legal authority and who is bound, rules and standard operating procedures specifying entitlement and eligibility, the named responsible agency across Union, state, district, local or parastatal levels, staff and money and technology including sanctioned against filled posts and the fund-flow route, the citizen interface of awareness and documents and distance and language and digital access, and grievance and review including appeal, penalty, evaluation and any sunset clause - and an enacted law can stall at any stage after the first. D. Environmental degradation is frequently produced not by an absence of policy but by mutually contradicting policies pursued by different ministries with separate mandates and no arbitration mechanism, because each sectoral ministry optimises its own objective

function, no single actor is accountable for the aggregate outcome, and the environmental cost is an externality that appears in nobody's departmental performance metric - although some contradictions are genuine value conflicts between livelihood today and ecological stock tomorrow rather than coordination failures.

Answer: C. Explanation: Any unfamiliar policy can be diagnosed through six stages - legal authority and who is bound, rules and standard operating procedures specifying entitlement and eligibility, the named responsible agency across Union, state, district, local or parastatal levels, staff and money and technology including sanctioned against filled posts and the fund-flow route, the citizen interface of awareness and documents and distance and language and digital access, and grievance and review including appeal, penalty, evaluation and any sunset clause - and an enacted law can stall at any stage after the first. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q52. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The six-stage implementation map?

A. PM GatiShakti is a National Master Plan approach for multi-modal infrastructure connectivity built on a shared geographic-information-system planning platform that layers infrastructure and utility data from multiple ministries, and its mechanism is the removal of sequencing failure and private-sector information risk through a common map, but it coordinates information rather than authority, since land, utilities and many approvals remain with states and local bodies. B. A public-private partnership is a procurement and service-delivery choice rather than privatisation by definition, and its governance chain runs from public purpose and output standard through risk allocation to the actor best able to manage each risk, competitive procurement with disclosed criteria, performance-linked payment, independent monitoring and contract disclosure, renegotiation and exit rules, to affordability and continuity safeguards, with Viability Gap Funding supporting economically justified but commercially weak projects and the Hybrid Annuity Model illustrating deliberate risk-sharing. C. Targeting concentrates scarce resources but requires identification machinery that itself excludes, while universalism avoids identification error at higher cost, and tightening verification reduces inclusion error where the ineligible are included while increasing exclusion error where the eligible are left out, so an entitlement affecting subsistence should fix the tolerable exclusion error first and add an offline or assisted fallback. D. Any unfamiliar policy can be diagnosed through six stages - legal authority and who is bound, rules and standard operating procedures specifying entitlement and eligibility, the named responsible agency across Union, state, district, local or parastatal levels, staff and money and technology including sanctioned against filled posts and the fund-flow route, the citizen interface of awareness and documents and distance and language and digital access, and grievance and review including appeal, penalty, evaluation and any sunset clause - and an enacted law can stall at any stage after the first.

Answer: D. Explanation: Any unfamiliar policy can be diagnosed through six stages - legal authority and who is bound, rules and standard operating procedures specifying entitlement and eligibility, the named responsible agency across Union, state, district, local or parastatal levels, staff and money and technology including sanctioned against filled posts and the fund-flow route, the citizen interface of awareness and documents and distance and language and digital access, and grievance and review including appeal, penalty, evaluation and any sunset clause - and an enacted law can stall at any stage after the first. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q53. Which statement correctly identifies The Aspirational Districts Programme design?

A. The Aspirational Districts Programme of NITI Aayog targets inter-district rather than inter-state divergence across 112 districts using 49 key performance indicators grouped into five themes - health and nutrition, education, agriculture and water resources, financial inclusion and skill development, and basic infrastructure - tracked on the Champions of Change dashboard, and it operates through the three named levers of convergence, collaboration including the Prabhari officer arrangement, and competition through delta ranking. B. Delta ranking scores the pace of improvement rather than the absolute level so that the historically worst-off district is not permanently bottom and therefore permanently unmotivated, while the dashboard data is largely district-self-reported with validation by selected agencies and the district unit can mask intra-district divergence, which is why the Aspirational Blocks Programme covering 513 blocks exists as a separate and non-substitutable unit and why the programme is best read as an administrative-attention and convergence instrument rather than a financing instrument. C. PM GatiShakti is a National Master Plan approach for multi-modal infrastructure connectivity built on a shared geographic-information-system planning platform that layers infrastructure and utility data from multiple ministries, and its mechanism is the removal of sequencing failure and private-sector information risk through a common map, but it

coordinates information rather than authority, since land, utilities and many approvals remain with states and local bodies. D. Environmental degradation is frequently produced not by an absence of policy but by mutually contradicting policies pursued by different ministries with separate mandates and no arbitration mechanism, because each sectoral ministry optimises its own objective function, no single actor is accountable for the aggregate outcome, and the environmental cost is an externality that appears in nobody's departmental performance metric - although some contradictions are genuine value conflicts between livelihood today and ecological stock tomorrow rather than coordination failures.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Aspirational Districts Programme of NITI Aayog targets inter-district rather than inter-state divergence across 112 districts using 49 key performance indicators grouped into five themes - health and nutrition, education, agriculture and water resources, financial inclusion and skill development, and basic infrastructure - tracked on the Champions of Change dashboard, and it operates through the three named levers of convergence, collaboration including the Prabhari officer arrangement, and competition through delta ranking. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q54. Which chronology card should be filed under The Aspirational Districts Programme design?

A. A public-private partnership is a procurement and service-delivery choice rather than privatisation by definition, and its governance chain runs from public purpose and output standard through risk allocation to the actor best able to manage each risk, competitive procurement with disclosed criteria, performance-linked payment, independent monitoring and contract disclosure, renegotiation and exit rules, to affordability and continuity safeguards, with Viability Gap Funding supporting economically justified but commercially weak projects and the Hybrid Annuity Model illustrating deliberate risk-sharing. B. The Aspirational Districts Programme of NITI Aayog targets inter-district rather than inter-state divergence across 112 districts using 49 key performance indicators grouped into five themes - health and nutrition, education, agriculture and water resources, financial inclusion and skill development, and basic infrastructure - tracked on the Champions of Change dashboard, and it operates through the three named levers of convergence, collaboration including the Prabhari officer arrangement, and competition through delta ranking. C. PM GatiShakti is a National Master Plan approach for multi-modal infrastructure connectivity built on a shared geographic-information-system planning platform that layers infrastructure and utility data from multiple ministries, and its mechanism is the removal of sequencing failure and private-sector information risk through a common map, but it coordinates information rather than authority, since land, utilities and many approvals remain with states and local bodies. D. Environmental degradation is frequently produced not by an absence of policy but by mutually contradicting policies pursued by different ministries with separate mandates and no arbitration mechanism, because each sectoral ministry optimises its own objective function, no single actor is accountable for the aggregate outcome, and the environmental cost is an externality that appears in nobody's departmental performance metric - although some contradictions are genuine value conflicts between livelihood today and ecological stock tomorrow rather than coordination failures.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Aspirational Districts Programme of NITI Aayog targets inter-district rather than inter-state divergence across 112 districts using 49 key performance indicators grouped into five themes - health and nutrition, education, agriculture and water resources, financial inclusion and skill development, and basic infrastructure - tracked on the Champions of Change dashboard, and it operates through the three named levers of convergence, collaboration including the Prabhari officer arrangement, and competition through delta ranking. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q55. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The Aspirational Districts Programme design?

A. A public-private partnership is a procurement and service-delivery choice rather than privatisation by definition, and its governance chain runs from public purpose and output standard through risk allocation to the actor best able to manage each risk, competitive procurement with disclosed criteria, performance-linked payment, independent monitoring and contract disclosure, renegotiation and exit rules, to affordability and continuity safeguards, with Viability Gap Funding supporting economically justified but commercially weak projects and the Hybrid Annuity Model illustrating deliberate risk-sharing. B. Targeting concentrates scarce resources but requires identification machinery that itself excludes, while universalism avoids identification error at higher cost, and tightening verification reduces inclusion error where the ineligible are included while increasing exclusion error where the eligible are left out, so an entitlement affecting subsistence should fix the tolerable exclusion error first and add an offline or assisted fallback. C.

The Aspirational Districts Programme of NITI Aayog targets inter-district rather than inter-state divergence across 112 districts using 49 key performance indicators grouped into five themes - health and nutrition, education, agriculture and water resources, financial inclusion and skill development, and basic infrastructure - tracked on the Champions of Change dashboard, and it operates through the three named levers of convergence, collaboration including the Prabhari officer arrangement, and competition through delta ranking. D. PM GatiShakti is a National Master Plan approach for multi-modal infrastructure connectivity built on a shared geographic-information-system planning platform that layers infrastructure and utility data from multiple ministries, and its mechanism is the removal of sequencing failure and private-sector information risk through a common map, but it coordinates information rather than authority, since land, utilities and many approvals remain with states and local bodies.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Aspirational Districts Programme of NITI Aayog targets inter-district rather than inter-state divergence across 112 districts using 49 key performance indicators grouped into five themes - health and nutrition, education, agriculture and water resources, financial inclusion and skill development, and basic infrastructure - tracked on the Champions of Change dashboard, and it operates through the three named levers of convergence, collaboration including the Prabhari officer arrangement, and competition through delta ranking. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q56. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The Aspirational Districts Programme design?

A. A public-private partnership is a procurement and service-delivery choice rather than privatisation by definition, and its governance chain runs from public purpose and output standard through risk allocation to the actor best able to manage each risk, competitive procurement with disclosed criteria, performance-linked payment, independent monitoring and contract disclosure, renegotiation and exit rules, to affordability and continuity safeguards, with Viability Gap Funding supporting economically justified but commercially weak projects and the Hybrid Annuity Model illustrating deliberate risk-sharing. B. The audited 2024-2025 Mains ledger routes the 2024 General Studies Paper-II demand on the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 to this Basic owner, while the audited 2018-2023 ledger routes three further demands - the 2018 General Studies Paper-I demand on aspirational districts, the 2018 General Studies Paper-II demand on policy contradictions and environmental degradation, and the 2022 General Studies Paper-II demand on Gati-Shakti coordination - to the Advanced owner, and the Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older Advanced pointer so that all four are answered from the core file. C. Targeting concentrates scarce resources but requires identification machinery that itself excludes, while universalism avoids identification error at higher cost, and tightening verification reduces inclusion error where the ineligible are included while increasing exclusion error where the eligible are left out, so an entitlement affecting subsistence should fix the tolerable exclusion error first and add an offline or assisted fallback. D. The Aspirational Districts Programme of NITI Aayog targets inter-district rather than inter-state divergence across 112 districts using 49 key performance indicators grouped into five themes - health and nutrition, education, agriculture and water resources, financial inclusion and skill development, and basic infrastructure - tracked on the Champions of Change dashboard, and it operates through the three named levers of convergence, collaboration including the Prabhari officer arrangement, and competition through delta ranking.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Aspirational Districts Programme of NITI Aayog targets inter-district rather than inter-state divergence across 112 districts using 49 key performance indicators grouped into five themes - health and nutrition, education, agriculture and water resources, financial inclusion and skill development, and basic infrastructure - tracked on the Champions of Change dashboard, and it operates through the three named levers of convergence, collaboration including the Prabhari officer arrangement, and competition through delta ranking. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q57. Which statement correctly identifies Delta ranking and the self-reported-data limit?

A. Delta ranking scores the pace of improvement rather than the absolute level so that the historically worst-off district is not permanently bottom and therefore permanently unmotivated, while the dashboard data is largely district-self-reported with validation by selected agencies and the district unit can mask intra-district divergence, which is why the Aspirational Blocks Programme covering 513 blocks exists as a separate and non-substitutable unit and why the programme is best read as an administrative-attention and convergence instrument rather than a financing instrument. B. A public-private partnership is a procurement and service-delivery choice rather than privatisation by definition, and its governance chain runs from public purpose and output standard through risk allocation to the actor best able to manage each risk, competitive procurement with disclosed criteria, performance-linked payment, independent monitoring and contract disclosure, renegotiation and exit rules, to affordability and continuity safeguards, with Viability Gap Funding supporting economically justified but commercially weak projects and the Hybrid Annuity Model illustrating deliberate risk-sharing. C. PM GatiShakti is a National Master Plan approach for multi-modal infrastructure connectivity built on a shared geographic-information-system planning platform that layers infrastructure and utility data from multiple ministries, and its mechanism is the removal of sequencing failure and private-sector information risk through a common map, but it coordinates information rather than authority, since land, utilities and many approvals remain with states and local bodies. D. Environmental degradation is frequently produced not by an absence of policy but by mutually contradicting policies pursued by different ministries with separate mandates and no arbitration mechanism, because each sectoral ministry optimises its own objective function, no single actor is accountable for the aggregate outcome, and the environmental cost is an externality that appears in nobody's departmental performance metric - although some contradictions are genuine value conflicts between livelihood today and ecological stock tomorrow rather than coordination failures.

Answer: A. Explanation: Delta ranking scores the pace of improvement rather than the absolute level so that the historically worst-off district is not permanently bottom and therefore permanently unmotivated, while the dashboard data is largely district-self-reported with validation by selected agencies and the district unit can mask intra-district divergence, which is why the Aspirational Blocks Programme covering 513 blocks exists as a separate and non-substitutable unit and why the programme is best read as an administrative-attention and convergence instrument rather than a financing instrument. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q58. Which chronology card should be filed under Delta ranking and the self-reported-data limit?

A. PM GatiShakti is a National Master Plan approach for multi-modal infrastructure connectivity built on a shared geographic-information-system planning platform that layers infrastructure and utility data from multiple ministries, and its mechanism is the removal of sequencing failure and private-sector information risk through a common map, but it coordinates information rather than authority, since land, utilities and many approvals remain with states and local bodies. B. Delta ranking scores the pace of improvement rather than the absolute level so that the historically worst-off district is not permanently bottom and therefore permanently unmotivated, while the dashboard data is largely district-self-reported with validation by selected agencies and the district unit can mask intra-district divergence, which is why the Aspirational Blocks Programme covering 513 blocks exists as a separate and non-substitutable unit and why the programme is best read as an administrative-attention and convergence instrument rather than a financing instrument. C. A public-private partnership is a procurement and service-delivery choice rather than privatisation by definition, and its governance chain runs from public purpose and output standard through risk allocation to the actor best able to manage each risk, competitive procurement with disclosed criteria, performance-linked payment, independent monitoring and contract disclosure, renegotiation and exit rules, to affordability and continuity safeguards, with Viability Gap Funding supporting economically justified but commercially weak projects and the Hybrid Annuity Model illustrating deliberate risk-sharing. D. Targeting concentrates scarce resources but requires identification machinery that itself excludes, while universalism avoids identification error at higher cost, and tightening verification reduces inclusion error where the ineligible are included while increasing exclusion error where the eligible are left out, so an entitlement affecting subsistence should fix the tolerable exclusion error first and add an offline or assisted fallback.

Answer: B. Explanation: Delta ranking scores the pace of improvement rather than the absolute level so that the historically worst-off district is not permanently bottom and therefore permanently unmotivated, while the dashboard data is largely district-self-reported with validation by selected agencies and the district unit can

mask intra-district divergence, which is why the Aspirational Blocks Programme covering 513 blocks exists as a separate and non-substitutable unit and why the programme is best read as an administrative-attention and convergence instrument rather than a financing instrument. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q59. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Delta ranking and the self-reported-data limit?

A. A public-private partnership is a procurement and service-delivery choice rather than privatisation by definition, and its governance chain runs from public purpose and output standard through risk allocation to the actor best able to manage each risk, competitive procurement with disclosed criteria, performance-linked payment, independent monitoring and contract disclosure, renegotiation and exit rules, to affordability and continuity safeguards, with Viability Gap Funding supporting economically justified but commercially weak projects and the Hybrid Annuity Model illustrating deliberate risk-sharing. B. Targeting concentrates scarce resources but requires identification machinery that itself excludes, while universalism avoids identification error at higher cost, and tightening verification reduces inclusion error where the ineligible are included while increasing exclusion error where the eligible are left out, so an entitlement affecting subsistence should fix the tolerable exclusion error first and add an offline or assisted fallback. C. Delta ranking scores the pace of improvement rather than the absolute level so that the historically worst-off district is not permanently bottom and therefore permanently unmotivated, while the dashboard data is largely district-self-reported with validation by selected agencies and the district unit can mask intra-district divergence, which is why the Aspirational Blocks Programme covering 513 blocks exists as a separate and non-substitutable unit and why the programme is best read as an administrative-attention and convergence instrument rather than a financing instrument. D. The audited 2024-2025 Mains ledger routes the 2024 General Studies Paper-II demand on the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 to this Basic owner, while the audited 2018-2023 ledger routes three further demands - the 2018 General Studies Paper-I demand on aspirational districts, the 2018 General Studies Paper-II demand on policy contradictions and environmental degradation, and the 2022 General Studies Paper-II demand on Gati-Shakti coordination - to the Advanced owner, and the Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older Advanced pointer so that all four are answered from the core file.

Answer: C. Explanation: Delta ranking scores the pace of improvement rather than the absolute level so that the historically worst-off district is not permanently bottom and therefore permanently unmotivated, while the dashboard data is largely district-self-reported with validation by selected agencies and the district unit can mask intra-district divergence, which is why the Aspirational Blocks Programme covering 513 blocks exists as a separate and non-substitutable unit and why the programme is best read as an administrative-attention and convergence instrument rather than a financing instrument. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q60. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Delta ranking and the self-reported-data limit?

A. Targeting concentrates scarce resources but requires identification machinery that itself excludes, while universalism avoids identification error at higher cost, and tightening verification reduces inclusion error where the ineligible are included while increasing exclusion error where the eligible are left out, so an entitlement affecting subsistence should fix the tolerable exclusion error first and add an offline or assisted fallback. B. The policy cycle - agenda setting, formulation, decision or enactment, implementation and evaluation, feeding back into agenda setting - is used analytically to locate exactly where a named policy is succeeding or failing, and the syllabus clause itself separates issues arising out of design from issues arising out of implementation. C. The audited 2024-2025 Mains ledger routes the 2024 General Studies Paper-II demand on the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 to this Basic owner, while the audited 2018-2023 ledger routes three further demands - the 2018 General Studies Paper-I demand on aspirational districts, the 2018 General Studies Paper-II demand on policy contradictions and environmental degradation, and the 2022 General Studies Paper-II demand on Gati-Shakti coordination - to the Advanced owner, and the Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older Advanced pointer so that all four are answered from the core file. D. Delta ranking scores the pace of improvement rather than the absolute level so that the historically worst-off district is not permanently bottom and therefore permanently unmotivated, while the dashboard data is largely district-self-reported with validation by selected agencies and the district unit can mask intra-district divergence, which is why the Aspirational Blocks Programme covering 513 blocks exists as a separate

and non-substitutable unit and why the programme is best read as an administrative-attention and convergence instrument rather than a financing instrument.

Answer: D. Explanation: Delta ranking scores the pace of improvement rather than the absolute level so that the historically worst-off district is not permanently bottom and therefore permanently unmotivated, while the dashboard data is largely district-self-reported with validation by selected agencies and the district unit can mask intra-district divergence, which is why the Aspirational Blocks Programme covering 513 blocks exists as a separate and non-substitutable unit and why the programme is best read as an administrative-attention and convergence instrument rather than a financing instrument. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q61. Which statement correctly identifies Policy contradiction as an externality problem?

A. Environmental degradation is frequently produced not by an absence of policy but by mutually contradicting policies pursued by different ministries with separate mandates and no arbitration mechanism, because each sectoral ministry optimises its own objective function, no single actor is accountable for the aggregate outcome, and the environmental cost is an externality that appears in nobody's departmental performance metric - although some contradictions are genuine value conflicts between livelihood today and ecological stock tomorrow rather than coordination failures. B. PM GatiShakti is a National Master Plan approach for multi-modal infrastructure connectivity built on a shared geographic-information-system planning platform that layers infrastructure and utility data from multiple ministries, and its mechanism is the removal of sequencing failure and private-sector information risk through a common map, but it coordinates information rather than authority, since land, utilities and many approvals remain with states and local bodies. C. A public-private partnership is a procurement and service-delivery choice rather than privatisation by definition, and its governance chain runs from public purpose and output standard through risk allocation to the actor best able to manage each risk, competitive procurement with disclosed criteria, performance-linked payment, independent monitoring and contract disclosure, renegotiation and exit rules, to affordability and continuity safeguards, with Viability Gap Funding supporting economically justified but commercially weak projects and the Hybrid Annuity Model illustrating deliberate risk-sharing. D. Targeting concentrates scarce resources but requires identification machinery that itself excludes, while universalism avoids identification error at higher cost, and tightening verification reduces inclusion error where the ineligible are included while increasing exclusion error where the eligible are left out, so an entitlement affecting subsistence should fix the tolerable exclusion error first and add an offline or assisted fallback.

Answer: A. Explanation: Environmental degradation is frequently produced not by an absence of policy but by mutually contradicting policies pursued by different ministries with separate mandates and no arbitration mechanism, because each sectoral ministry optimises its own objective function, no single actor is accountable for the aggregate outcome, and the environmental cost is an externality that appears in nobody's departmental performance metric - although some contradictions are genuine value conflicts between livelihood today and ecological stock tomorrow rather than coordination failures. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q62. Which chronology card should be filed under Policy contradiction as an externality problem?

A. Targeting concentrates scarce resources but requires identification machinery that itself excludes, while universalism avoids identification error at higher cost, and tightening verification reduces inclusion error where the ineligible are included while increasing exclusion error where the eligible are left out, so an entitlement affecting subsistence should fix the tolerable exclusion error first and add an offline or assisted fallback. B. Environmental degradation is frequently produced not by an absence of policy but by mutually contradicting policies pursued by different ministries with separate mandates and no arbitration mechanism, because each sectoral ministry optimises its own objective function, no single actor is accountable for the aggregate outcome, and the environmental cost is an externality that appears in nobody's departmental performance metric - although some contradictions are genuine value conflicts between livelihood today and ecological stock tomorrow rather than coordination failures. C. The audited 2024-2025 Mains ledger routes the 2024 General Studies Paper-II demand on the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 to this Basic owner, while the audited 2018-2023 ledger routes three further demands - the 2018 General Studies Paper-I demand on aspirational districts, the 2018 General Studies Paper-II demand on policy contradictions and environmental degradation, and the 2022 General Studies Paper-II demand on

Gati-Shakti coordination - to the Advanced owner, and the Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older Advanced pointer so that all four are answered from the core file. D. A public-private partnership is a procurement and service-delivery choice rather than privatisation by definition, and its governance chain runs from public purpose and output standard through risk allocation to the actor best able to manage each risk, competitive procurement with disclosed criteria, performance-linked payment, independent monitoring and contract disclosure, renegotiation and exit rules, to affordability and continuity safeguards, with Viability Gap Funding supporting economically justified but commercially weak projects and the Hybrid Annuity Model illustrating deliberate risk-sharing.

Answer: B. Explanation: Environmental degradation is frequently produced not by an absence of policy but by mutually contradicting policies pursued by different ministries with separate mandates and no arbitration mechanism, because each sectoral ministry optimises its own objective function, no single actor is accountable for the aggregate outcome, and the environmental cost is an externality that appears in nobody's departmental performance metric - although some contradictions are genuine value conflicts between livelihood today and ecological stock tomorrow rather than coordination failures. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q63. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Policy contradiction as an externality problem?

A. The policy cycle - agenda setting, formulation, decision or enactment, implementation and evaluation, feeding back into agenda setting - is used analytically to locate exactly where a named policy is succeeding or failing, and the syllabus clause itself separates issues arising out of design from issues arising out of implementation. B. The audited 2024-2025 Mains ledger routes the 2024 General Studies Paper-II demand on the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 to this Basic owner, while the audited 2018-2023 ledger routes three further demands - the 2018 General Studies Paper-I demand on aspirational districts, the 2018 General Studies Paper-II demand on policy contradictions and environmental degradation, and the 2022 General Studies Paper-II demand on Gati-Shakti coordination - to the Advanced owner, and the Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older Advanced pointer so that all four are answered from the core file. C. Environmental degradation is frequently produced not by an absence of policy but by mutually contradicting policies pursued by different ministries with separate mandates and no arbitration mechanism, because each sectoral ministry optimises its own objective function, no single actor is accountable for the aggregate outcome, and the environmental cost is an externality that appears in nobody's departmental performance metric - although some contradictions are genuine value conflicts between livelihood today and ecological stock tomorrow rather than coordination failures. D. Targeting concentrates scarce resources but requires identification machinery that itself excludes, while universalism avoids identification error at higher cost, and tightening verification reduces inclusion error where the ineligible are included while increasing exclusion error where the eligible are left out, so an entitlement affecting subsistence should fix the tolerable exclusion error first and add an offline or assisted fallback.

Answer: C. Explanation: Environmental degradation is frequently produced not by an absence of policy but by mutually contradicting policies pursued by different ministries with separate mandates and no arbitration mechanism, because each sectoral ministry optimises its own objective function, no single actor is accountable for the aggregate outcome, and the environmental cost is an externality that appears in nobody's departmental performance metric - although some contradictions are genuine value conflicts between livelihood today and ecological stock tomorrow rather than coordination failures. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q64. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Policy contradiction as an externality problem?

A. The policy cycle - agenda setting, formulation, decision or enactment, implementation and evaluation, feeding back into agenda setting - is used analytically to locate exactly where a named policy is succeeding or failing, and the syllabus clause itself separates issues arising out of design from issues arising out of implementation. B. The implementation gap is the difference between the policy as designed or announced and the policy as actually delivered on the ground, and it is the multiplicative product of design realism, the count of independent approval points and the quality of frontline discretion rather than a synonym for corruption. C. The audited 2024-2025 Mains ledger routes the 2024 General Studies Paper-II demand on the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 to this Basic owner, while the audited 2018-2023 ledger routes three further demands - the 2018 General Studies

Paper-I demand on aspirational districts, the 2018 General Studies Paper-II demand on policy contradictions and environmental degradation, and the 2022 General Studies Paper-II demand on Gati-Shakti coordination - to the Advanced owner, and the Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older Advanced pointer so that all four are answered from the core file. D. Environmental degradation is frequently produced not by an absence of policy but by mutually contradicting policies pursued by different ministries with separate mandates and no arbitration mechanism, because each sectoral ministry optimises its own objective function, no single actor is accountable for the aggregate outcome, and the environmental cost is an externality that appears in nobody's departmental performance metric - although some contradictions are genuine value conflicts between livelihood today and ecological stock tomorrow rather than coordination failures.

Answer: D. Explanation: Environmental degradation is frequently produced not by an absence of policy but by mutually contradicting policies pursued by different ministries with separate mandates and no arbitration mechanism, because each sectoral ministry optimises its own objective function, no single actor is accountable for the aggregate outcome, and the environmental cost is an externality that appears in nobody's departmental performance metric - although some contradictions are genuine value conflicts between livelihood today and ecological stock tomorrow rather than coordination failures. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q65. Which statement correctly identifies PM GatiShakti as an information layer?

A. PM GatiShakti is a National Master Plan approach for multi-modal infrastructure connectivity built on a shared geographic-information-system planning platform that layers infrastructure and utility data from multiple ministries, and its mechanism is the removal of sequencing failure and private-sector information risk through a common map, but it coordinates information rather than authority, since land, utilities and many approvals remain with states and local bodies. B. Targeting concentrates scarce resources but requires identification machinery that itself excludes, while universalism avoids identification error at higher cost, and tightening verification reduces inclusion error where the ineligible are included while increasing exclusion error where the eligible are left out, so an entitlement affecting subsistence should fix the tolerable exclusion error first and add an offline or assisted fallback. C. A public-private partnership is a procurement and service-delivery choice rather than privatisation by definition, and its governance chain runs from public purpose and output standard through risk allocation to the actor best able to manage each risk, competitive procurement with disclosed criteria, performance-linked payment, independent monitoring and contract disclosure, renegotiation and exit rules, to affordability and continuity safeguards, with Viability Gap Funding supporting economically justified but commercially weak projects and the Hybrid Annuity Model illustrating deliberate risk-sharing. D. The audited 2024-2025 Mains ledger routes the 2024 General Studies Paper-II demand on the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 to this Basic owner, while the audited 2018-2023 ledger routes three further demands - the 2018 General Studies Paper-I demand on aspirational districts, the 2018 General Studies Paper-II demand on policy contradictions and environmental degradation, and the 2022 General Studies Paper-II demand on Gati-Shakti coordination - to the Advanced owner, and the Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older Advanced pointer so that all four are answered from the core file.

Answer: A. Explanation: PM GatiShakti is a National Master Plan approach for multi-modal infrastructure connectivity built on a shared geographic-information-system planning platform that layers infrastructure and utility data from multiple ministries, and its mechanism is the removal of sequencing failure and private-sector information risk through a common map, but it coordinates information rather than authority, since land, utilities and many approvals remain with states and local bodies. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q66. Which chronology card should be filed under PM GatiShakti as an information layer?

A. The policy cycle - agenda setting, formulation, decision or enactment, implementation and evaluation, feeding back into agenda setting - is used analytically to locate exactly where a named policy is succeeding or failing, and the syllabus clause itself separates issues arising out of design from issues arising out of implementation. B. PM GatiShakti is a National Master Plan approach for multi-modal infrastructure connectivity built on a shared geographic-information-system planning platform that layers infrastructure and utility data from multiple ministries, and its mechanism is the removal of sequencing failure and private-sector information risk through a common map, but it coordinates information rather than authority, since land, utilities and many approvals remain with states and local bodies. C. The audited 2024-2025 Mains ledger routes the 2024 General Studies Paper-II demand on the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 to this Basic owner, while the audited 2018-2023 ledger routes three further demands - the 2018 General Studies Paper-I demand on aspirational districts, the 2018 General Studies Paper-II demand on policy contradictions and environmental degradation, and the 2022 General Studies Paper-II demand on Gati-Shakti coordination - to the Advanced owner, and the Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older Advanced pointer so that all four are answered from the core file. D. Targeting concentrates scarce resources but requires identification machinery that itself excludes, while universalism avoids identification error at higher cost, and tightening verification reduces inclusion error where the ineligible are included while increasing exclusion error where the eligible are left out, so an entitlement affecting subsistence should fix the tolerable exclusion error first and add an offline or assisted fallback.

Answer: B. Explanation: PM GatiShakti is a National Master Plan approach for multi-modal infrastructure connectivity built on a shared geographic-information-system planning platform that layers infrastructure and utility data from multiple ministries, and its mechanism is the removal of sequencing failure and private-sector information risk through a common map, but it coordinates information rather than authority, since land, utilities and many approvals remain with states and local bodies. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q67. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of PM GatiShakti as an information layer?

A. The policy cycle - agenda setting, formulation, decision or enactment, implementation and evaluation, feeding back into agenda setting - is used analytically to locate exactly where a named policy is succeeding or failing, and the syllabus clause itself separates issues arising out of design from issues arising out of implementation. B. The implementation gap is the difference between the policy as designed or announced and the policy as actually delivered on the ground, and it is the multiplicative product of design realism, the count of independent approval points and the quality of frontline discretion rather than a synonym for corruption. C. PM GatiShakti is a National Master Plan approach for multi-modal infrastructure connectivity built on a shared geographic-information-system planning platform that layers infrastructure and utility data from multiple ministries, and its mechanism is the removal of sequencing failure and private-sector information risk through a common map, but it coordinates information rather than authority, since land, utilities and many approvals remain with states and local bodies. D. The audited 2024-2025 Mains ledger routes the 2024 General Studies Paper-II demand on the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 to this Basic owner, while the audited 2018-2023 ledger routes three further demands - the 2018 General Studies Paper-I demand on aspirational districts, the 2018 General Studies Paper-II demand on policy contradictions and environmental degradation, and the 2022 General Studies Paper-II demand on Gati-Shakti coordination - to the Advanced owner, and the Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older Advanced pointer so that all four are answered from the core file.

Answer: C. Explanation: PM GatiShakti is a National Master Plan approach for multi-modal infrastructure connectivity built on a shared geographic-information-system planning platform that layers infrastructure and utility data from multiple ministries, and its mechanism is the removal of sequencing failure and private-sector information risk through a common map, but it coordinates information rather than authority, since land, utilities and many approvals remain with states and local bodies. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q68. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about PM GatiShakti as an information layer?

A. The policy cycle - agenda setting, formulation, decision or enactment, implementation and evaluation, feeding back into agenda setting - is used analytically to locate exactly where a named policy is succeeding or failing, and the syllabus clause itself separates issues arising out of design from issues arising out of implementation. B. Pressman and Wildavsky established that each additional actor, level of government or approval step is a clearance point, and that the cumulative probability of delay or distortion rises sharply as clearance points multiply even where each individual point is separately likely to succeed, which is why a centrally sponsored scheme requiring Union, state, district and panchayat sign-off is structurally more gap-prone than a single-agency central-sector scheme. C. The implementation gap is the difference between the policy as designed or announced and the policy as actually delivered on the ground, and it is the multiplicative product of design realism, the count of independent approval points and the quality of frontline discretion rather than a synonym for corruption. D. PM GatiShakti is a National Master Plan approach for multi-modal infrastructure connectivity built on a shared geographic-information-system planning platform that layers infrastructure and utility data from multiple ministries, and its mechanism is the removal of sequencing failure and private-sector information risk through a common map, but it coordinates information rather than authority, since land, utilities and many approvals remain with states and local bodies.

Answer: D. Explanation: PM GatiShakti is a National Master Plan approach for multi-modal infrastructure connectivity built on a shared geographic-information-system planning platform that layers infrastructure and utility data from multiple ministries, and its mechanism is the removal of sequencing failure and private-sector information risk through a common map, but it coordinates information rather than authority, since land, utilities and many approvals remain with states and local bodies. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q69. Which statement correctly identifies Public-private partnership governance?

A. A public-private partnership is a procurement and service-delivery choice rather than privatisation by definition, and its governance chain runs from public purpose and output standard through risk allocation to the actor best able to manage each risk, competitive procurement with disclosed criteria, performance-linked payment, independent monitoring and contract disclosure, renegotiation and exit rules, to affordability and continuity safeguards, with Viability Gap Funding supporting economically justified but commercially weak projects and the Hybrid Annuity Model illustrating deliberate risk-sharing. B. The policy cycle - agenda setting, formulation, decision or enactment, implementation and evaluation, feeding back into agenda setting - is used analytically to locate exactly where a named policy is succeeding or failing, and the syllabus clause itself separates issues arising out of design from issues arising out of implementation. C. Targeting concentrates scarce resources but requires identification machinery that itself excludes, while universalism avoids identification error at higher cost, and tightening verification reduces inclusion error where the ineligible are included while increasing exclusion error where the eligible are left out, so an entitlement affecting subsistence should fix the tolerable exclusion error first and add an offline or assisted fallback. D. The audited 2024-2025 Mains ledger routes the 2024 General Studies Paper-II demand on the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 to this Basic owner, while the audited 2018-2023 ledger routes three further demands - the 2018 General Studies Paper-I demand on aspirational districts, the 2018 General Studies Paper-II demand on policy contradictions and environmental degradation, and the 2022 General Studies Paper-II demand on Gati-Shakti coordination - to the Advanced owner, and the Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older Advanced pointer so that all four are answered from the core file.

Answer: A. Explanation: A public-private partnership is a procurement and service-delivery choice rather than privatisation by definition, and its governance chain runs from public purpose and output standard through risk allocation to the actor best able to manage each risk, competitive procurement with disclosed criteria, performance-linked payment, independent monitoring and contract disclosure, renegotiation and exit rules, to affordability and continuity safeguards, with Viability Gap Funding supporting economically justified but commercially weak projects and the Hybrid Annuity Model illustrating deliberate risk-sharing. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q70. Which chronology card should be filed under Public-private partnership governance?

A. The audited 2024-2025 Mains ledger routes the 2024 General Studies Paper-II demand on the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 to this Basic owner, while the audited 2018-2023 ledger routes three further demands - the 2018 General Studies Paper-I demand on aspirational districts, the 2018 General Studies Paper-II demand on policy contradictions and environmental degradation, and the 2022 General Studies Paper-II demand on Gati-Shakti coordination - to the Advanced owner, and the Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older Advanced pointer so that all four are answered from the core file. B. A public-private partnership is a procurement and service-delivery choice rather than privatisation by definition, and its governance chain runs from public purpose and output standard through risk allocation to the actor best able to manage each risk, competitive procurement with disclosed criteria, performance-linked payment, independent monitoring and contract disclosure, renegotiation and exit rules, to affordability and continuity safeguards, with Viability Gap Funding supporting economically justified but commercially weak projects and the Hybrid Annuity Model illustrating deliberate risk-sharing. C. The implementation gap is the difference between the policy as designed or announced and the policy as actually delivered on the ground, and it is the multiplicative product of design realism, the count of independent approval points and the quality of frontline discretion rather than a synonym for corruption. D. The policy cycle - agenda setting, formulation, decision or enactment, implementation and evaluation, feeding back into agenda setting - is used analytically to locate exactly where a named policy is succeeding or failing, and the syllabus clause itself separates issues arising out of design from issues arising out of implementation.

Answer: B. Explanation: A public-private partnership is a procurement and service-delivery choice rather than privatisation by definition, and its governance chain runs from public purpose and output standard through risk allocation to the actor best able to manage each risk, competitive procurement with disclosed criteria, performance-linked payment, independent monitoring and contract disclosure, renegotiation and exit rules, to affordability and continuity safeguards, with Viability Gap Funding supporting economically justified but commercially weak projects and the Hybrid Annuity Model illustrating deliberate risk-sharing. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q71. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Public-private partnership governance?

A. The policy cycle - agenda setting, formulation, decision or enactment, implementation and evaluation, feeding back into agenda setting - is used analytically to locate exactly where a named policy is succeeding or failing, and the syllabus clause itself separates issues arising out of design from issues arising out of implementation. B. Pressman and Wildavsky established that each additional actor, level of government or approval step is a clearance point, and that the cumulative probability of delay or distortion rises sharply as clearance points multiply even where each individual point is separately likely to succeed, which is why a centrally sponsored scheme requiring Union, state, district and panchayat sign-off is structurally more gap-prone than a single-agency central-sector scheme. C. A public-private partnership is a procurement and service-delivery choice rather than privatisation by definition, and its governance chain runs from public purpose and output standard through risk allocation to the actor best able to manage each risk, competitive procurement with disclosed criteria, performance-linked payment, independent monitoring and contract disclosure, renegotiation and exit rules, to affordability and continuity safeguards, with Viability Gap Funding supporting economically justified but commercially weak projects and the Hybrid Annuity Model illustrating deliberate risk-sharing. D. The implementation gap is the difference between the policy as designed or announced and the policy as actually delivered on the ground, and it is the multiplicative product of design realism, the count of independent approval points and the quality of frontline discretion rather than a synonym for corruption.

Answer: C. Explanation: A public-private partnership is a procurement and service-delivery choice rather than privatisation by definition, and its governance chain runs from public purpose and output standard through risk allocation to the actor best able to manage each risk, competitive procurement with disclosed criteria, performance-linked payment, independent monitoring and contract disclosure, renegotiation and exit rules, to affordability and continuity safeguards, with Viability Gap Funding supporting economically justified but commercially weak projects and the Hybrid Annuity Model illustrating deliberate risk-sharing. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q72. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Public-private partnership governance?

A. Pressman and Wildavsky established that each additional actor, level of government or approval step is a clearance point, and that the cumulative probability of delay or distortion rises sharply as clearance points multiply even where each individual point is separately likely to succeed, which is why a centrally sponsored scheme requiring Union, state, district and panchayat sign-off is structurally more gap-prone than a single-agency central-sector scheme. B. The implementation gap is the difference between the policy as designed or announced and the policy as actually delivered on the ground, and it is the multiplicative product of design realism, the count of independent approval points and the quality of frontline discretion rather than a synonym for corruption. C. Michael Lipsky's street-level bureaucracy thesis holds that frontline officials such as teachers, police, ration-shop dealers, auxiliary nurse midwives and examination-centre invigilators exercise substantial discretion and in effect make policy through their daily choices, so the policy a citizen experiences is what the frontline official actually does rather than what the scheme guideline says. D. A public-private partnership is a procurement and service-delivery choice rather than privatisation by definition, and its governance chain runs from public purpose and output standard through risk allocation to the actor best able to manage each risk, competitive procurement with disclosed criteria, performance-linked payment, independent monitoring and contract disclosure, renegotiation and exit rules, to affordability and continuity safeguards, with Viability Gap Funding supporting economically justified but commercially weak projects and the Hybrid Annuity Model illustrating deliberate risk-sharing.

Answer: D. Explanation: A public-private partnership is a procurement and service-delivery choice rather than privatisation by definition, and its governance chain runs from public purpose and output standard through risk allocation to the actor best able to manage each risk, competitive procurement with disclosed criteria, performance-linked payment, independent monitoring and contract disclosure, renegotiation and exit rules, to affordability and continuity safeguards, with Viability Gap Funding supporting economically justified but commercially weak projects and the Hybrid Annuity Model illustrating deliberate risk-sharing. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Targeting error and the universalism trade-off?

A. Targeting concentrates scarce resources but requires identification machinery that itself excludes, while universalism avoids identification error at higher cost, and tightening verification reduces inclusion error where the ineligible are included while increasing exclusion error where the eligible are left out, so an entitlement affecting subsistence should fix the tolerable exclusion error first and add an offline or assisted fallback. B. The policy cycle - agenda setting, formulation, decision or enactment, implementation and evaluation, feeding back into agenda setting - is used analytically to locate exactly where a named policy is succeeding or failing, and the syllabus clause itself separates issues arising out of design from issues arising out of implementation. C. The implementation gap is the difference between the policy as designed or announced and the policy as actually delivered on the ground, and it is the multiplicative product of design realism, the count of independent approval points and the quality of frontline discretion rather than a synonym for corruption. D. The audited 2024-2025 Mains ledger routes the 2024 General Studies Paper-II demand on the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 to this Basic owner, while the audited 2018-2023 ledger routes three further demands - the 2018 General Studies Paper-I demand on aspirational districts, the 2018 General Studies Paper-II demand on policy contradictions and environmental degradation, and the 2022 General Studies Paper-II demand on Gati-Shakti coordination - to the Advanced owner, and the Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older Advanced pointer so that all four are answered from the core file.

Answer: A. Explanation: Targeting concentrates scarce resources but requires identification machinery that itself excludes, while universalism avoids identification error at higher cost, and tightening verification reduces inclusion error where the ineligible are included while increasing exclusion error where the eligible are left out, so an entitlement affecting subsistence should fix the tolerable exclusion error first and add an offline or assisted fallback. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q74. Which chronology card should be filed under Targeting error and the universalism trade-off?

A. Pressman and Wildavsky established that each additional actor, level of government or approval step is a clearance point, and that the cumulative probability of delay or distortion rises sharply as clearance points multiply even where each individual point is separately likely to succeed, which is why a centrally sponsored scheme requiring Union, state, district and panchayat sign-off is structurally more gap-prone than a single-agency central-sector scheme. B. Targeting concentrates scarce resources but requires identification machinery that itself excludes, while universalism avoids identification error at higher cost, and tightening verification reduces inclusion error where the ineligible are included while increasing exclusion error where the eligible are left out, so an entitlement affecting subsistence should fix the tolerable exclusion error first and add an offline or assisted fallback. C. The implementation gap is the difference between the policy as designed or announced and the policy as actually delivered on the ground, and it is the multiplicative product of design realism, the count of independent approval points and the quality of frontline discretion rather than a synonym for corruption. D. The policy cycle - agenda setting, formulation, decision or enactment, implementation and evaluation, feeding back into agenda setting - is used analytically to locate exactly where a named policy is succeeding or failing, and the syllabus clause itself separates issues arising out of design from issues arising out of implementation.

Answer: B. Explanation: Targeting concentrates scarce resources but requires identification machinery that itself excludes, while universalism avoids identification error at higher cost, and tightening verification reduces inclusion error where the ineligible are included while increasing exclusion error where the eligible are left out, so an entitlement affecting subsistence should fix the tolerable exclusion error first and add an offline or assisted fallback. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q75. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Targeting error and the universalism trade-off?

A. The implementation gap is the difference between the policy as designed or announced and the policy as actually delivered on the ground, and it is the multiplicative product of design realism, the count of independent approval points and the quality of frontline discretion rather than a synonym for corruption. B. Pressman and Wildavsky established that each additional actor, level of government or approval step is a clearance point, and that the cumulative probability of delay or distortion rises sharply as clearance points multiply even where each individual point is separately likely to succeed, which is why a centrally sponsored scheme requiring Union, state, district and panchayat sign-off is structurally more gap-prone than a single-agency central-sector scheme. C. Targeting concentrates scarce resources but requires identification machinery that itself excludes, while universalism avoids identification error at higher cost, and tightening verification reduces inclusion error where the ineligible are included while increasing exclusion error where the eligible are left out, so an entitlement affecting subsistence should fix the tolerable exclusion error first and add an offline or assisted fallback. D. Michael Lipsky's street-level bureaucracy thesis holds that frontline officials such as teachers, police, ration-shop dealers, auxiliary nurse midwives and examination-centre invigilators exercise substantial discretion and in effect make policy through their daily choices, so the policy a citizen experiences is what the frontline official actually does rather than what the scheme guideline says.

Answer: C. Explanation: Targeting concentrates scarce resources but requires identification machinery that itself excludes, while universalism avoids identification error at higher cost, and tightening verification reduces inclusion error where the ineligible are included while increasing exclusion error where the eligible are left out, so an entitlement affecting subsistence should fix the tolerable exclusion error first and add an offline or assisted fallback. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q76. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Targeting error and the universalism trade-off?

A. Lipsky identifies predictable coping routines under heavy caseload and resource scarcity - rationing time and attention, creaming by serving the easier cases first, and informal rule-bending - and these routines explain welfare exclusion error without alleging corruption, which is the analytical wedge that separates a diagnosed answer from a complaint. B. Pressman and Wildavsky established that each additional actor, level of government or approval step is a clearance point, and that the cumulative probability of delay or distortion rises sharply as clearance points multiply even where each individual point is separately likely to succeed, which is why a centrally sponsored scheme requiring Union, state, district and panchayat sign-off is structurally more gap-prone than a single-agency central-sector scheme. C. Michael Lipsky's street-level bureaucracy thesis holds that frontline officials such as teachers, police, ration-shop dealers, auxiliary nurse midwives and examination-centre invigilators exercise substantial discretion and in effect make policy through their daily choices, so the policy a citizen experiences is what the frontline official actually does rather than what the scheme guideline says. D. Targeting concentrates scarce resources but requires identification machinery that itself excludes, while universalism avoids identification error at higher cost, and tightening verification reduces inclusion error where the ineligible are included while increasing exclusion error where the eligible are left out, so an entitlement affecting subsistence should fix the tolerable exclusion error first and add an offline or assisted fallback.

Answer: D. Explanation: Targeting concentrates scarce resources but requires identification machinery that itself excludes, while universalism avoids identification error at higher cost, and tightening verification reduces inclusion error where the ineligible are included while increasing exclusion error where the eligible are left out, so an entitlement affecting subsistence should fix the tolerable exclusion error first and add an offline or assisted fallback. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Verified question ownership across two ledgers?

A. The audited 2024-2025 Mains ledger routes the 2024 General Studies Paper-II demand on the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 to this Basic owner, while the audited 2018-2023 ledger routes three further demands - the 2018 General Studies Paper-I demand on aspirational districts, the 2018 General Studies Paper-II demand on policy contradictions and environmental degradation, and the 2022 General Studies Paper-II demand on Gati-Shakti coordination - to the Advanced owner, and the Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older Advanced pointer so that all four are answered from the core file. B. Pressman and Wildavsky established that each additional actor, level of government or approval step is a clearance point, and that the cumulative probability of delay or distortion rises sharply as clearance points multiply even where each individual point is separately likely to succeed, which is why a centrally sponsored scheme requiring Union, state, district and panchayat sign-off is structurally more gap-prone than a single-agency central-sector scheme. C. The policy cycle - agenda setting, formulation, decision or enactment, implementation and evaluation, feeding back into agenda setting - is used analytically to locate exactly where a named policy is succeeding or failing, and the syllabus clause itself separates issues arising out of design from issues arising out of implementation. D. The implementation gap is the difference between the policy as designed or announced and the policy as actually delivered on the ground, and it is the multiplicative product of design realism, the count of independent approval points and the quality of frontline discretion rather than a synonym for corruption.

Answer: A. Explanation: The audited 2024-2025 Mains ledger routes the 2024 General Studies Paper-II demand on the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 to this Basic owner, while the audited 2018-2023 ledger routes three further demands - the 2018 General Studies Paper-I demand on aspirational districts, the 2018 General Studies Paper-II demand on policy contradictions and environmental degradation, and the 2022 General Studies Paper-II demand on Gati-Shakti coordination - to the Advanced owner, and the Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older Advanced pointer so that all four are answered from the core file. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under Verified question ownership across two ledgers?

A. The implementation gap is the difference between the policy as designed or announced and the policy as actually delivered on the ground, and it is the multiplicative product of design realism, the count of independent approval points and the quality of frontline discretion rather than a synonym for corruption. B. The audited 2024-2025 Mains ledger routes the 2024 General Studies Paper-II demand on the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 to this Basic owner, while the audited 2018-2023 ledger routes three further demands - the 2018 General Studies Paper-I demand on aspirational districts, the 2018 General Studies Paper-II demand on policy contradictions and environmental degradation, and the 2022 General Studies Paper-II demand on Gati-Shakti coordination - to the Advanced owner, and the Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older Advanced pointer so that all four are answered from the core file. C. Michael Lipsky's street-level bureaucracy thesis holds that frontline officials such as teachers, police, ration-shop dealers, auxiliary nurse midwives and examination-centre invigilators exercise substantial discretion and in effect make policy through their daily choices, so the policy a citizen experiences is what the frontline official actually does rather than what the scheme guideline says. D. Pressman and Wildavsky established that each additional actor, level of government or approval step is a clearance point, and that the cumulative probability of delay or distortion rises sharply as clearance points multiply even where each individual point is separately likely to succeed, which is why a centrally sponsored scheme requiring Union, state, district and panchayat sign-off is structurally more gap-prone than a single-agency central-sector scheme.

Answer: B. Explanation: The audited 2024-2025 Mains ledger routes the 2024 General Studies Paper-II demand on the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 to this Basic owner, while the audited 2018-2023 ledger routes three further demands - the 2018 General Studies Paper-I demand on aspirational districts, the 2018 General Studies Paper-II demand on policy contradictions and environmental degradation, and the 2022 General Studies Paper-II demand on Gati-Shakti coordination - to the Advanced owner, and the Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older Advanced pointer so that all four are answered from the core file. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Verified question ownership across two ledgers?

A. Pressman and Wildavsky established that each additional actor, level of government or approval step is a clearance point, and that the cumulative probability of delay or distortion rises sharply as clearance points multiply even where each individual point is separately likely to succeed, which is why a centrally sponsored scheme requiring Union, state, district and panchayat sign-off is structurally more gap-prone than a single-agency central-sector scheme. B. Michael Lipsky's street-level bureaucracy thesis holds that frontline officials such as teachers, police, ration-shop dealers, auxiliary nurse midwives and examination-centre invigilators exercise substantial discretion and in effect make policy through their daily choices, so the policy a citizen experiences is what the frontline official actually does rather than what the scheme guideline says. C. The audited 2024-2025 Mains ledger routes the 2024 General Studies Paper-II demand on the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 to this Basic owner, while the audited 2018-2023 ledger routes three further demands - the 2018 General Studies Paper-I demand on aspirational districts, the 2018 General Studies Paper-II demand on policy contradictions and environmental degradation, and the 2022 General Studies Paper-II demand on Gati-Shakti coordination - to the Advanced owner, and the Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older Advanced pointer so that all four are answered from the core file. D. Lipsky identifies predictable coping routines under heavy caseload and resource scarcity - rationing time and attention, creaming by serving the easier cases first, and informal rule-bending - and these routines explain welfare exclusion error without alleging corruption, which is the analytical wedge that separates a diagnosed answer from a complaint.

Answer: C. Explanation: The audited 2024-2025 Mains ledger routes the 2024 General Studies Paper-II demand on the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 to this Basic owner, while the audited 2018-2023 ledger routes three further demands - the 2018 General Studies Paper-I demand on aspirational districts, the 2018 General Studies Paper-II demand on policy contradictions and environmental degradation, and the 2022 General Studies Paper-II demand on Gati-Shakti coordination - to the Advanced owner, and the Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older Advanced pointer so that all four

are answered from the core file. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Verified question ownership across two ledgers?

A. Lipsky identifies predictable coping routines under heavy caseload and resource scarcity - rationing time and attention, creaming by serving the easier cases first, and informal rule-bending - and these routines explain welfare exclusion error without alleging corruption, which is the analytical wedge that separates a diagnosed answer from a complaint. B. Michael Lipsky's street-level bureaucracy thesis holds that frontline officials such as teachers, police, ration-shop dealers, auxiliary nurse midwives and examination-centre invigilators exercise substantial discretion and in effect make policy through their daily choices, so the policy a citizen experiences is what the frontline official actually does rather than what the scheme guideline says. C. A top-down reading asks whether frontline action matched the original design while a bottom-up reading treats frontline output as the real policy regardless of design intent, and neither view alone is complete, so a strong answer reframes the question of whether an Act worked into the question of what the designated centres and officials actually did. D. The audited 2024-2025 Mains ledger routes the 2024 General Studies Paper-II demand on the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 to this Basic owner, while the audited 2018-2023 ledger routes three further demands - the 2018 General Studies Paper-I demand on aspirational districts, the 2018 General Studies Paper-II demand on policy contradictions and environmental degradation, and the 2022 General Studies Paper-II demand on Gati-Shakti coordination - to the Advanced owner, and the Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older Advanced pointer so that all four are answered from the core file.

Answer: D. Explanation: The audited 2024-2025 Mains ledger routes the 2024 General Studies Paper-II demand on the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 to this Basic owner, while the audited 2018-2023 ledger routes three further demands - the 2018 General Studies Paper-I demand on aspirational districts, the 2018 General Studies Paper-II demand on policy contradictions and environmental degradation, and the 2022 General Studies Paper-II demand on Gati-Shakti coordination - to the Advanced owner, and the Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older Advanced pointer so that all four are answered from the core file. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT

Four direct General Studies Mains demands are routed to this topic across the audited ledgers and every one of them was confirmed word for word in the locally held OCR-searchable official question papers. The audited 2024-2025 ledger routes the 2024 General Studies Paper-II demand on the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 to the Basic owner. The audited 2018-2023 ledger routes three further demands to the Advanced owner - the 2018 General Studies Paper-I demand on the transformation of aspirational districts, the 2018 General Studies Paper-II demand on policy contradictions and environmental degradation, and the 2022 General Studies Paper-II demand on Gati-Shakti coordination between the government and the private sector - and the 2018 Paper-I entry itself carries the ledger's own note that the printed stem is partly word-scrambled in the scan. The Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older Advanced pointer, so all four are answered from the core file rather than from the optional advanced block. No official answer key or marking scheme is held locally for any of them, so each model solution below is an authored answer route and not an official key, and the objective ledgers route no Preliminary demand to this owner.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT", every clause, exact authority and institutional boundary, an implementation chain, stakeholder/accountability map, Centre-state-local allocation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, safeguards and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the governance demand in "VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT".

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Define the governance concept and separate it from the nearest legal, institutional or measured category. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Identify the constitutional, statutory, delegated or executive authority and the competent level of government. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Map state, market, civil-society, frontline and citizen stakeholders with power, duty and vulnerability. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Trace finance, information, implementation, monitoring, grievance, appeal and correction through the delivery chain. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** Use a named Indian law, institution, scheme, audit, reform or local example with source, date and operative status. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
6. **Claim and named evidence:** Test exclusion, digital divide, privacy, capture, capacity, indicator gaming, trade-off and residual-risk limits. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional value, commission recommendation, scheme catalogue, budget allocation, portal, disposal count or ranking cannot alone establish lawful authority, inclusive implementation, substantive remedy or attributable outcome; test capacity, federal competence, distribution, privacy, audit, appeal and current operative status.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the governance demand in "VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT".

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing authority -> institution -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; define and state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for inclusion, privacy, federal, indicator, grievance and current-status limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains implementation rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, federal, institutional, causal and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT", replace the weakest catalogue-style point with one named duty-holder, legal or executive basis, delivery bottleneck, process and outcome indicator, grievance route and evidence-status qualification.

OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS

9. PYQ application

- FACT: 2024 Q11: "What are the aims and objects of ... The Public Examination (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024? Whether University/State Education Board examinations, too, are covered under the Act?" - answer must state the Act's stated aims (preventing unfair means, protecting the credibility of public examinations) and then directly address the scope question rather than describing the Act generically.
- FACT: 2024 Q17: "In a crucial domain like the public healthcare system the Indian State should play a vital role to contain the adverse impact of marketisation... Suggest some measures through which the State can enhance the reach of public healthcare at the grassroots level" - frame the answer using the design (regulation of private marketisation) and delivery (grassroots primary health strengthening) distinction from this file; do not drift into Social-Justice-owned scheme-listing without a governance lens.

Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

Status: 2024-2025 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2024-2025.md.

- **Years represented:** 2024
- **Paper(s):** GS-II
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2024	GS-II	11	Public Examination (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024	Discuss · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Public Examination (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024

This block integrates the 2024-2025 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 block and does not convert an unkeyed/answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

10. PYQ-based analytical application

- FACT: 2024 Q11 rewards precisely distinguishing the Act's *stated aims* from its **scope* question* (university/state board coverage) - use the clearance-point/notification logic from this file to answer the scope half analytically rather than descriptively.
- FACT: 2024 Q17 rewards treating public-healthcare marketisation as both a design problem (financing/regulatory structure) and a delivery problem (grassroots reach) - use the design-realism vs street-level-discretion distinction (Section 2) as the answer's spine.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md.

- **Years represented:** 2018, 2022
- **Paper(s):** GS-I, GS-II
- **Routed question demands:** 3

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2018	GS-I	17	Transformation of aspirational districts and convergence strategy	Mention and explain · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic; printed stem partly word-scrambled in scan	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2018	GS-II	6	Policy contradictions across sectors and environmental degradation	Comment with relevant illustrations · 10 marks · 150 words	Cross-cutting; policy design and environmental regulation both linked	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2022	GS-II	6	Gati-Shakti and coordination between government and private sector	Discuss · 10 marks · 150 words	Cross-cutting; Economy infrastructure route terminates in answer-complete Core	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Transformation of aspirational districts and convergence strategy
- Policy contradictions across sectors and environmental degradation
- Gati-Shakti and coordination between government and private sector

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2024 General Studies Paper-II

Demand: What are the aims and objects of recently passed and enforced, The Public Examination (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024? Whether University/State Education Board examinations, too, are covered under the Act? Discuss in 250 words for 15 marks.

Status: Routed to the Basic owner by the audited 2024-2025 Mains ledger and confirmed word for word in the locally held official 2024 General Studies Paper-II. No official answer key is held locally, so the model solution is an authored route.

Model solution: Answer in two labelled halves because the stem asks two separate things. First state the aims: the Act prevents and penalises unfair means in public examinations, defining offences such as question-paper leak, impersonation and tampering, and its object is protecting the credibility of public recruitment and admission examinations. Name the commencement precisely, 21 June 2024 by notification S.O. 2422(E), because a recently enforced statute demand rewards the date. Second, answer the scope question directly rather than describing the Act again: coverage is authority-based, the Schedule names central authorities including the Union Public Service Commission, the Staff Selection Commission, Railway Recruitment Boards, the Institute of Banking Personnel Selection, the National Testing Agency and Central Government departments and attached offices, and further authorities may be added by Central Government notification. It follows that a university or state education board examination is not automatically covered merely because the Act extends to India; inclusion requires notification of that authority or separate state legislation, and an executive statement of adoption is not a notification. Then add the analysis the directive expects: enactment is only the first of six implementation stages, so the deterrent effect will be determined by designated authorities, rules, investigation capacity and examination-centre practice rather than by the statute alone. Qualify honestly - the Act creates offences and designated authorities but does not by itself supply the forensic, invigilation and coordination capacity that detection requires, and no conviction, detection or deterrence figure is available here. Conclude that the aims are integrity-protective and general while the reach is authority-based and therefore specific, and that conflating the two is the error the scope half of the question is designed to expose.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2024 General Studies Paper-II", every clause, exact authority and institutional boundary, an implementation chain, stakeholder/accountability map, Centre-state-local allocation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, safeguards and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Answer in two labelled halves because the stem asks two separate things. First state the aims: the Act prevents and penalises unfair means in public examinations, defining offences such as question-paper leak, impersonation and tampering, and its object is protecting the credibility of public recruitment and admission examinations. Name the commencement precisely, 21 June 2024 by notification S.O. 2422(E), because a recently enforced statute demand rewards the date. Second, answer the scope question directly rather than describing the Act again: coverage is authority-based, the Schedule names central authorities including the Union Public Service Commission, the Staff Selection Commission, Railway Recruitment Boards, the Institute of Banking Personnel Selection, the National Testing Agency and Central Government departments and attached offices, and further authorities may be added by Central Government notification. It follows that a university or state education board examination is not automatically covered merely because the Act extends to India; inclusion requires notification of that authority or separate state legislation, and an executive statement of adoption is not a notification. Then add the analysis the directive expects: enactment is only the first of six implementation stages, so the deterrent effect will be determined by designated authorities, rules, investigation capacity and examination-centre practice rather than by the statute alone. Qualify honestly - the Act creates offences and designated authorities but does not by itself supply the forensic, invigilation and coordination capacity that detection requires, and no conviction, detection or deterrence figure is available here. Conclude that the aims are integrity-protective and general while the reach is authority-based and therefore specific, and that conflating the two is the error the scope half of the question is designed to expose.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2024 General Studies Paper-II **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional value, commission recommendation, scheme catalogue, budget allocation, portal, disposal count or ranking cannot alone establish lawful authority, inclusive implementation, substantive remedy or attributable outcome; test capacity, federal competence, distribution, privacy, audit, appeal and current operative status.

Qualified conclusion: Answer in two labelled halves because the stem asks two separate things. First state the aims: the Act prevents and penalises unfair means in public examinations, defining offences such as question-paper leak, impersonation and tampering, and its object is protecting the credibility of public recruitment and admission examinations. Name the commencement precisely, 21 June 2024 by notification S.O. 2422(E), because a recently enforced statute demand rewards the date. Second, answer the scope question directly rather than describing the Act again: coverage is authority-based, the Schedule names central authorities including the Union Public Service Commission, the Staff Selection Commission, Railway Recruitment Boards, the Institute of Banking Personnel Selection, the National Testing Agency and Central Government departments and attached offices, and further authorities may be added by Central Government notification. It follows that a university or state education board examination is not automatically covered merely because the Act extends to India; inclusion requires notification of that authority or separate state legislation, and an executive statement of adoption is not a notification. Then add the analysis the directive expects: enactment is only the first of six implementation stages, so the deterrent effect will be determined by designated authorities, rules, investigation capacity and examination-centre practice rather than by the statute alone. Qualify honestly - the Act creates offences and designated authorities but does not by itself supply the forensic, invigilation and coordination capacity that detection requires, and no conviction, detection or deterrence figure is available here. Conclude that the aims are integrity-protective and general while the reach is authority-based and therefore specific, and that conflating the two is the error the scope half of the question is designed to expose.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing authority -> institution -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; define and state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for inclusion, privacy, federal, indicator, grievance and current-status limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains implementation rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, federal, institutional, causal and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2024 General Studies Paper-II", replace the weakest catalogue-style point with one named duty-holder, legal or executive basis, delivery bottleneck, process and outcome indicator, grievance route and evidence-status qualification.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2018 General Studies Paper-I

Demand: Mention core strategies for the transformation of aspirational districts in India and explain the nature of convergence, collaboration and competition for its success. Answer in 250 words for 15 marks.

Status: Routed by the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger to the Advanced owner with the ledger's own note that the printed stem is partly word-scrambled in the scan; the stem was nevertheless confirmed word for word in the locally held official 2018 General Studies Paper-I. The Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older Advanced pointer. No official answer key is held locally.

Model solution: Open by naming the problem the programme addresses, because the targeting unit is the analytical core: inter-district rather than inter-state divergence, a unit smaller than the state and larger than the block. State the design with its exact figures - the NITI Aayog Aspirational Districts Programme covering 112 districts, measured on 49 key performance indicators grouped into five themes of health and nutrition, education, agriculture and water resources, financial inclusion and skill development, and basic infrastructure, tracked on the Champions of Change dashboard. Then explain each of the three named levers in the programme's own logic rather than as adjectives. Convergence aligns Union and state schemes on one district outcome and its governance value is that it removes clearance points between parallel schemes instead of adding a new scheme. Collaboration operates through Union, state and district officials working with the Prabhari officer arrangement, which supplies supervisory attention that ordinary line administration does not. Competition operates through delta ranking, and the analytically interesting choice is that ranking on the pace of improvement rather than the absolute level prevents the historically worst-off district from being permanently bottom and therefore permanently unmotivated. State the limitations honestly: dashboard data is largely district-self-reported with validation by selected agencies, an indicator improvement is an output measure rather than a realised outcome, and the district unit can mask intra-district divergence at block and habitation level, which is why the Aspirational Blocks Programme covering 513 blocks exists as a separate and non-substitutable unit. Conclude that the programme is best read as an administrative-attention and convergence instrument that re-allocates supervisory intensity rather than primarily money, and assert no district rank, indicator value or expenditure figure.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2018 General Studies Paper-I", every clause, exact authority and institutional boundary, an implementation chain, stakeholder/accountability map, Centre-state-local allocation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, safeguards and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Open by naming the problem the programme addresses, because the targeting unit is the analytical core: inter-district rather than inter-state divergence, a unit smaller than the state and larger than the block. State the design with its exact figures - the NITI Aayog Aspirational Districts Programme covering 112 districts, measured on 49 key performance indicators grouped into five themes of health and nutrition, education, agriculture and water resources, financial inclusion and skill development, and basic infrastructure, tracked on the Champions of Change dashboard. Then explain each of the three named levers in the programme's own logic rather than as adjectives. Convergence aligns Union and state schemes on one district outcome and its governance value is that it removes clearance points between parallel schemes instead of adding a new scheme. Collaboration operates through Union, state and district officials working with the Prabhari officer arrangement, which supplies supervisory attention that ordinary line administration does not. Competition operates through delta ranking, and the analytically interesting choice is that ranking on the pace of improvement rather than the absolute level prevents the historically worst-off district from being permanently bottom and therefore permanently unmotivated. State the limitations honestly: dashboard data is largely district-self-reported with validation by selected agencies, an indicator improvement is an output measure rather than a realised outcome, and the district unit can mask intra-district divergence at block and habitation level, which is why the Aspirational Blocks Programme covering 513 blocks exists as a separate and non-substitutable unit. Conclude that the programme is best read as an administrative-attention and convergence instrument that re-allocates supervisory intensity rather than primarily money, and assert no district rank, indicator value or expenditure figure.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2018 General Studies Paper-I **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Demand: Mention core strategies for the transformation of aspirational districts in India and explain the nature of convergence, collaboration and competition for its success. Answer in 250 words for 15 marks. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional value, commission recommendation, scheme catalogue, budget allocation, portal, disposal count or ranking cannot alone establish lawful authority, inclusive implementation, substantive remedy or attributable outcome; test capacity, federal competence, distribution, privacy, audit, appeal and current operative status.

Qualified conclusion: Open by naming the problem the programme addresses, because the targeting unit is the analytical core: inter-district rather than inter-state divergence, a unit smaller than the state and larger than the block. State the design with its exact figures - the NITI Aayog Aspirational Districts Programme covering 112 districts, measured on 49 key performance indicators grouped into five themes of health and nutrition, education, agriculture and water resources, financial inclusion and skill development, and basic infrastructure, tracked on the Champions of Change dashboard. Then explain each of the three named levers in the programme's own logic rather than as adjectives. Convergence aligns Union and state schemes on one district outcome and its governance value is that it removes clearance points between parallel schemes instead of adding a new scheme. Collaboration operates through Union, state and district officials working with the Prabhari officer arrangement, which supplies supervisory attention that ordinary line administration does not. Competition operates through delta ranking, and the analytically interesting choice is that ranking on the pace of improvement rather than the absolute level prevents the historically worst-off district from being permanently bottom and therefore permanently unmotivated. State the limitations honestly: dashboard data is largely district-self-reported with validation by selected agencies, an indicator improvement is an output measure rather than a realised outcome, and the district unit can mask intra-district divergence at block and habitation level, which is why the Aspirational Blocks Programme covering 513 blocks exists as a separate and non-substitutable unit. Conclude that the programme is best read as an administrative-attention and convergence instrument that re-allocates supervisory intensity rather than primarily money, and assert no district rank, indicator value or expenditure figure.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing authority -> institution -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; define and state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for inclusion, privacy, federal, indicator, grievance and current-status limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains implementation rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, federal, institutional, causal and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2018 General Studies Paper-I", replace the weakest catalogue-style point with one named duty-holder, legal or executive basis, delivery bottleneck, process and outcome indicator, grievance route and evidence-status qualification.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2018 General Studies Paper-II

Demand: Policy contradictions among various competing sectors and stakeholders have resulted in inadequate protection and prevention of degradation to environment. Comment with relevant illustrations in 150 words for 10 marks.

Status: Routed by the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger to the Advanced owner as a cross-cutting demand linked to both policy design and environmental regulation, and confirmed in the locally held official 2018 General Studies Paper-II. The Basic owner answers it under core routing. No official answer key is held locally.

Model solution: Take a position in the first sentence because comment permits an argued view: environmental degradation in India is frequently produced not by an absence of policy but by mutually contradicting policies pursued by different ministries with separate mandates and no arbitration mechanism. Give the mechanism precisely rather than the sentiment, since this is where the marks sit: each sectoral ministry optimises its own objective function, no single actor is accountable for the aggregate environmental outcome, and the environmental cost is an externality that appears in nobody's departmental performance metric. Make the illustrations structural rather than anecdotal - input and price support that encourages water-intensive cropping in a water-stressed region while a separate programme funds groundwater conservation, energy-access expansion running against emission-reduction commitments, and infrastructure-clearance timelines running against impact-assessment depth. Name the governance correctives and attach each to the stage it fixes: regulatory impact assessment at formulation, inter-ministerial appraisal before notification, convergence at the district level, and outcome indicators that carry the environmental externality. Then supply the counterpoint that lifts the answer: some contradictions are genuine value conflicts between livelihood today and ecological stock tomorrow rather than coordination failures, and better process alone cannot resolve them. Cross-link the environmental impact assessment and tribunal machinery to the Environment owner rather than restating it, and invent no degradation statistic, ministry position or scheme name. Conclude that coordination reform is necessary but insufficient, because a contradiction rooted in a value conflict requires a political choice that no appraisal procedure can make on its behalf.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2018 General Studies Paper-II", every clause, exact authority and institutional boundary, an implementation chain, stakeholder/accountability map, Centre-state-local allocation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, safeguards and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Take a position in the first sentence because comment permits an argued view: environmental degradation in India is frequently produced not by an absence of policy but by mutually contradicting policies pursued by different ministries with separate mandates and no arbitration mechanism. Give the mechanism precisely rather than the sentiment, since this is where the marks sit: each sectoral ministry optimises its own objective function, no single actor is accountable for the aggregate environmental outcome, and the environmental cost is an externality that appears in nobody's departmental performance metric. Make the illustrations structural rather than anecdotal - input and price support that encourages water-intensive cropping in a water-stressed region while a separate programme funds groundwater conservation, energy-access expansion running against emission-reduction commitments, and infrastructure-clearance timelines running against impact-assessment depth. Name the governance correctives and attach each to the stage it fixes: regulatory impact assessment at formulation, inter-ministerial appraisal before notification, convergence at the district level, and outcome indicators that carry the environmental externality. Then supply the counterpoint that lifts the answer: some contradictions are genuine value conflicts between livelihood today and ecological stock tomorrow rather than coordination failures, and better process alone cannot resolve them. Cross-link the environmental impact assessment and tribunal machinery to the Environment owner rather than restating it, and invent no degradation statistic, ministry position or scheme name. Conclude that coordination reform is necessary but insufficient, because a contradiction rooted in a value conflict requires a political choice that no appraisal procedure can make on its behalf.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2018 General Studies Paper-II **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional value, commission recommendation, scheme catalogue, budget allocation, portal, disposal count or ranking cannot alone establish lawful authority, inclusive implementation, substantive remedy or attributable outcome; test capacity, federal competence, distribution, privacy, audit, appeal and current operative status.

Qualified conclusion: Take a position in the first sentence because comment permits an argued view: environmental degradation in India is frequently produced not by an absence of policy but by mutually contradicting policies pursued by different ministries with separate mandates and no arbitration mechanism. Give the mechanism precisely rather than the sentiment, since this is where the marks sit: each sectoral ministry optimises its own objective function, no single actor is accountable for the aggregate environmental outcome, and the environmental cost is an externality that appears in nobody's departmental performance metric. Make the illustrations structural rather than anecdotal - input and price support that encourages water-intensive cropping in a water-stressed region while a separate programme funds groundwater conservation, energy-access expansion running against emission-reduction commitments, and infrastructure-clearance timelines running against impact-assessment depth. Name the governance correctives and attach each to the stage it fixes: regulatory impact assessment at formulation, inter-ministerial appraisal before notification, convergence at the district level, and outcome indicators that carry the environmental externality. Then supply the counterpoint that lifts the answer: some contradictions are genuine value conflicts between livelihood today and ecological stock tomorrow rather than coordination failures, and better process alone cannot resolve them. Cross-link the environmental impact assessment and tribunal machinery to the Environment owner rather than restating it, and invent no degradation statistic, ministry position or scheme name. Conclude that coordination reform is necessary but insufficient, because a contradiction rooted in a value conflict requires a political choice that no appraisal procedure can make on its behalf.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing authority -> institution -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; define and state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for inclusion, privacy, federal, indicator, grievance and current-status limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains implementation rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, federal, institutional, causal and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2018 General Studies Paper-II", replace the weakest catalogue-style point with one named duty-holder, legal or executive basis, delivery bottleneck, process and outcome indicator, grievance route and evidence-status qualification.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 4 - 2022 General Studies Paper-II

Demand: The Gati-Shakti Yojana needs meticulous coordination between the government and the private sector to achieve the goal of connectivity. Discuss in 150 words for 10 marks.

Status: Routed by the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger to the Advanced owner as a cross-cutting demand whose Economy infrastructure route terminates in the answer-complete core file, and confirmed word for word in the locally held official 2022 General Studies Paper-II. No official answer key is held locally.

Model solution: Classify the question correctly in the opening line, because misclassification is the commonest failure here: this is a coordination and information-asymmetry problem rather than an infrastructure-finance problem, so the governance content is the institutional answer to siloed planning. Describe the design only to the extent verified - PM GatiShakti is a National Master Plan approach for multi-modal infrastructure connectivity built on a shared geographic-information-system planning platform that layers infrastructure and utility data from multiple ministries so that projects are planned against a common map rather than in isolation. State the mechanism in two steps. Within government, a shared data layer removes the sequencing failures that arise when each ministry plans on its own data, the familiar case being a road surfaced and then dug up for a utility line. Toward the private sector, the same layer reduces information risk, because a bidder can see planned alignments and utility corridors, so the state's contribution is de-risking through predictability rather than direct subsidy. Then state the governance limitation squarely: a planning platform coordinates information, not authority, since land, utilities and many approvals remain with states and local bodies, so visibility improves without resolving federal or jurisdictional friction. Add the contractual layer where private participation is actually procured - risk allocated to the actor best able to manage it, competitive procurement with disclosed criteria, performance-linked payment, independent monitoring and disclosed contracts, and renegotiation

and exit rules - noting that Viability Gap Funding and the Hybrid Annuity Model show that risk transfer is deliberately varied rather than uniform. Conclude that the reform is an information-layer reform whose value depends on data currency and on state participation, and assert no investment figure, ministry count, target date or logistics-cost percentage.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "PYQ DEMAND CARD 4 - 2022 General Studies Paper-II", every clause, exact authority and institutional boundary, an implementation chain, stakeholder/accountability map, Centre-state-local allocation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, safeguards and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Classify the question correctly in the opening line, because misclassification is the commonest failure here: this is a coordination and information-asymmetry problem rather than an infrastructure-finance problem, so the governance content is the institutional answer to siloed planning. Describe the design only to the extent verified - PM GatiShakti is a National Master Plan approach for multi-modal infrastructure connectivity built on a shared geographic-information-system planning platform that layers infrastructure and utility data from multiple ministries so that projects are planned against a common map rather than in isolation. State the mechanism in two steps. Within government, a shared data layer removes the sequencing failures that arise when each ministry plans on its own data, the familiar case being a road surfaced and then dug up for a utility line. Toward the private sector, the same layer reduces information risk, because a bidder can see planned alignments and utility corridors, so the state's contribution is de-risking through predictability rather than direct subsidy. Then state the governance limitation squarely: a planning platform coordinates information, not authority, since land, utilities and many approvals remain with states and local bodies, so visibility improves without resolving federal or jurisdictional friction. Add the contractual layer where private participation is actually procured - risk allocated to the actor best able to manage it, competitive procurement with disclosed criteria, performance-linked payment, independent monitoring and disclosed contracts, and renegotiation and exit rules - noting that Viability Gap Funding and the Hybrid Annuity Model show that risk transfer is deliberately varied rather than uniform. Conclude that the reform is an information-layer reform whose value depends on data currency and on state participation, and assert no investment figure, ministry count, target date or logistics-cost percentage.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** PYQ DEMAND CARD 4 - 2022 General Studies Paper-II **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Demand: The Gati-Shakti Yojana needs meticulous coordination between the government and the private sector to achieve the goal of connectivity. Discuss in 150 words for 10 marks. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional value, commission recommendation, scheme catalogue, budget allocation, portal, disposal count or ranking cannot alone establish lawful authority, inclusive implementation, substantive remedy or attributable outcome; test capacity, federal competence, distribution, privacy, audit, appeal and current operative status.

Qualified conclusion: Classify the question correctly in the opening line, because misclassification is the commonest failure here: this is a coordination and information-asymmetry problem rather than an infrastructure-finance problem, so the governance content is the institutional answer to siloed planning. Describe the design only to the extent verified - PM GatiShakti is a National Master Plan approach for multi-modal infrastructure connectivity built on a shared geographic-information-system planning platform that layers infrastructure and utility data from multiple ministries so that projects are planned against a common map rather than in isolation. State the mechanism in two steps. Within government, a shared data layer removes the sequencing failures that arise when each ministry plans on its own data, the familiar case being a road surfaced and then dug up for a utility line. Toward the private sector, the same layer reduces information risk, because a bidder can see planned alignments and utility corridors, so the state's contribution

is de-risking through predictability rather than direct subsidy. Then state the governance limitation squarely: a planning platform coordinates information, not authority, since land, utilities and many approvals remain with states and local bodies, so visibility improves without resolving federal or jurisdictional friction. Add the contractual layer where private participation is actually procured - risk allocated to the actor best able to manage it, competitive procurement with disclosed criteria, performance-linked payment, independent monitoring and disclosed contracts, and renegotiation and exit rules - noting that Viability Gap Funding and the Hybrid Annuity Model show that risk transfer is deliberately varied rather than uniform. Conclude that the reform is an information-layer reform whose value depends on data currency and on state participation, and assert no investment figure, ministry count, target date or logistics-cost percentage.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing authority -> institution -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; define and state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for inclusion, privacy, federal, indicator, grievance and current-status limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains implementation rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, federal, institutional, causal and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 4 - 2022 General Studies Paper-II", replace the weakest catalogue-style point with one named duty-holder, legal or executive basis, delivery bottleneck, process and outcome indicator, grievance route and evidence-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Explain the implementation gap in public policy and locate its causes on the policy cycle with an Indian illustration. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: The gap is the multiplicative product of design realism, clearance-point count and frontline discretion quality, so an answer that names the stage at which a specific policy stops diagnoses the failure while one that asserts poor implementation only describes it.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The policy cycle - agenda setting, formulation, decision or enactment, implementation and evaluation, feeding back into agenda setting - is used analytically to locate exactly where a named policy is succeeding or failing, and the syllabus clause itself separates issues arising out of design from issues arising out of implementation.
- The implementation gap is the difference between the policy as designed or announced and the policy as actually delivered on the ground, and it is the multiplicative product of design realism, the count of independent approval points and the quality of frontline discretion rather than a synonym for corruption.
- Pressman and Wildavsky established that each additional actor, level of government or approval step is a clearance point, and that the cumulative probability of delay or distortion rises sharply as clearance points multiply even where each individual point is separately likely to succeed, which is why a centrally sponsored scheme requiring Union, state, district and panchayat sign-off is structurally more gap-prone than a single-agency central-sector scheme.

Qualified conclusion: The gap is the multiplicative product of design realism, clearance-point count and frontline discretion quality, so an answer that names the stage at which a specific policy stops diagnoses the failure while one that asserts poor implementation only describes it.

Demand decoding: The directive **explain** requires a direct position on "Explain the implementation gap in public policy and locate its causes on the policy cycle...", every clause, exact authority and institutional boundary, an implementation chain, stakeholder/accountability map, Centre-state-local allocation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, safeguards and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The gap is the multiplicative product of design realism, clearance-point count and frontline discretion quality, so an answer that names the stage at which a specific policy stops diagnoses the failure while one that asserts poor implementation only describes it.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The policy cycle - agenda setting, formulation, decision or enactment, implementation and evaluation, feeding back into agenda setting - is used analytically to locate exactly where a named policy is succeeding or failing, and the syllabus clause itself separates issues arising out of design from issues arising out of implementation. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The implementation gap is the difference between the policy as designed or announced and the policy as actually delivered on the ground, and it is the multiplicative product of design realism, the count of independent approval points and the quality of frontline discretion rather than a synonym for corruption. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Pressman and Wildavsky established that each additional actor, level of government or approval step is a clearance point, and that the cumulative probability of delay or distortion rises sharply as clearance points multiply even where each individual point is separately likely to succeed, which is why a centrally sponsored scheme requiring Union, state, district and panchayat sign-off is structurally more gap-prone than a single-agency central-sector scheme. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional value, commission recommendation, scheme catalogue, budget allocation, portal, disposal count or ranking cannot alone establish lawful authority, inclusive implementation, substantive remedy or attributable outcome; test capacity, federal competence, distribution, privacy, audit, appeal and current operative status.

Qualified conclusion: The gap is the multiplicative product of design realism, clearance-point count and frontline discretion quality, so an answer that names the stage at which a specific policy stops diagnoses the failure while one that asserts poor implementation only describes it.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing authority -> institution -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; define and state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for inclusion, privacy, federal, indicator, grievance and current-status limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains implementation rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, federal, institutional, causal and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Explain the implementation gap in public policy and locate its causes on the policy cycle...", replace the weakest catalogue-style point with one named duty-holder, legal or executive basis, delivery bottleneck, process and outcome indicator, grievance route and evidence-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Explain why street-level discretion should be guided rather than eliminated in Indian welfare delivery. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Discretion is not eliminable and can adapt policy humanely or ration it arbitrarily, so the governance task is clear entitlement rules, reasoned rejection, recorded decisions and an appeal rather than an unattainable demand for uniformity.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Michael Lipsky's street-level bureaucracy thesis holds that frontline officials such as teachers, police, ration-shop dealers, auxiliary nurse midwives and examination-centre invigilators exercise substantial discretion and in effect make policy through their daily choices, so the policy a citizen experiences is what the frontline official actually does rather than what the scheme guideline says.

- Lipsky identifies predictable coping routines under heavy caseload and resource scarcity - rationing time and attention, creaming by serving the easier cases first, and informal rule-bending - and these routines explain welfare exclusion error without alleging corruption, which is the analytical wedge that separates a diagnosed answer from a complaint.
- A top-down reading asks whether frontline action matched the original design while a bottom-up reading treats frontline output as the real policy regardless of design intent, and neither view alone is complete, so a strong answer reframes the question of whether an Act worked into the question of what the designated centres and officials actually did.

Qualified conclusion: Discretion is not eliminable and can adapt policy humanely or ration it arbitrarily, so the governance task is clear entitlement rules, reasoned rejection, recorded decisions and an appeal rather than an unattainable demand for uniformity.

Demand decoding: The directive **explain** requires a direct position on "Explain why street-level discretion should be guided rather than eliminated in Indian welfare...", every clause, exact authority and institutional boundary, an implementation chain, stakeholder/accountability map, Centre-state-local allocation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, safeguards and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Discretion is not eliminable and can adapt policy humanely or ration it arbitrarily, so the governance task is clear entitlement rules, reasoned rejection, recorded decisions and an appeal rather than an unattainable demand for uniformity.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Michael Lipsky's street-level bureaucracy thesis holds that frontline officials such as teachers, police, ration-shop dealers, auxiliary nurse midwives and examination-centre invigilators exercise substantial discretion and in effect make policy through their daily choices, so the policy a citizen experiences is what the frontline official actually does rather than what the scheme guideline says. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Lipsky identifies predictable coping routines under heavy caseload and resource scarcity - rationing time and attention, creaming by serving the easier cases first, and informal rule-bending - and these routines explain welfare exclusion error without alleging corruption, which is the analytical wedge that separates a diagnosed answer from a complaint. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** A top-down reading asks whether frontline action matched the original design while a bottom-up reading treats frontline output as the real policy regardless of design intent, and neither view alone is complete, so a strong answer reframes the question of whether an Act worked into the question of what the designated centres and officials actually did. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional value, commission recommendation, scheme catalogue, budget allocation, portal, disposal count or ranking cannot alone establish lawful authority, inclusive implementation, substantive remedy or attributable outcome; test capacity, federal competence, distribution, privacy, audit, appeal and current operative status.

Qualified conclusion: Discretion is not eliminable and can adapt policy humanely or ration it arbitrarily, so the governance task is clear entitlement rules, reasoned rejection, recorded decisions and an appeal rather than an unattainable demand for uniformity.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing authority -> institution -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; define and state a thesis; write four to

seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for inclusion, privacy, federal, indicator, grievance and current-status limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains implementation rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, federal, institutional, causal and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Explain why street-level discretion should be guided rather than eliminated in Indian welfare...", replace the weakest catalogue-style point with one named duty-holder, legal or executive basis, delivery bottleneck, process and outcome indicator, grievance route and evidence-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Examine the aims of the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 and the separate question of its coverage. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: The aims are integrity-protective and general while the reach is authority-based and therefore specific, and conflating the two is precisely the error the scope half of the demand is designed to expose.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 was enacted to prevent and penalise unfair means such as question-paper leaks, impersonation and tampering in public examinations, it came into force on 21 June 2024 by notification S.O. 2422(E), and its scheduled central authorities include the Union Public Service Commission, the Staff Selection Commission, Railway Recruitment Boards, the Institute of Banking Personnel Selection, Central Government departments and attached offices, and the National Testing Agency.
- Coverage under the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 is authority-based rather than subject-matter-based or territorial, so a state board or university examination is not automatically covered merely because the Act extends to India, and inclusion requires either notification of that authority by the Central Government or separate state legislation, which is precisely the scope half of the 2024 demand and the point an aims-only answer misses.
- Any unfamiliar policy can be diagnosed through six stages - legal authority and who is bound, rules and standard operating procedures specifying entitlement and eligibility, the named responsible agency across Union, state, district, local or parastatal levels, staff and money and technology including sanctioned against filled posts and the fund-flow route, the citizen interface of awareness and documents and distance and language and digital access, and grievance and review including appeal, penalty, evaluation and any sunset clause - and an enacted law can stall at any stage after the first.
- The Pre-Legislative Consultation Policy of 2014 advises Union departments to publish draft legislation with an explanatory note and an ordinary minimum public comment window of about thirty days before introduction, and it is an executive policy rather than a statute whose comments are not binding, so publishing a draft is consultation compliance while incorporating feedback is consultation depth.

Qualified conclusion: The aims are integrity-protective and general while the reach is authority-based and therefore specific, and conflating the two is precisely the error the scope half of the demand is designed to expose.

Demand decoding: The directive **examine** requires a direct position on "Examine the aims of the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 and the...", every clause, exact authority and institutional boundary, an implementation chain, stakeholder/accountability map, Centre-state-local allocation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, safeguards and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The aims are integrity-protective and general while the reach is authority-based and therefore specific, and conflating the two is precisely the error the scope half of the demand is designed to expose.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 was enacted to prevent and penalise unfair means such as question-paper leaks, impersonation and tampering in public examinations, it came into force on 21 June 2024 by notification S.O. 2422(E), and its scheduled central authorities include the Union Public Service Commission, the Staff Selection Commission, Railway Recruitment Boards, the Institute of Banking Personnel Selection, Central Government departments and attached offices, and

the National Testing Agency. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

2. **Claim and named evidence:** Coverage under the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 is authority-based rather than subject-matter-based or territorial, so a state board or university examination is not automatically covered merely because the Act extends to India, and inclusion requires either notification of that authority by the Central Government or separate state legislation, which is precisely the scope half of the 2024 demand and the point an aims-only answer misses. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Any unfamiliar policy can be diagnosed through six stages - legal authority and who is bound, rules and standard operating procedures specifying entitlement and eligibility, the named responsible agency across Union, state, district, local or parastatal levels, staff and money and technology including sanctioned against filled posts and the fund-flow route, the citizen interface of awareness and documents and distance and language and digital access, and grievance and review including appeal, penalty, evaluation and any sunset clause - and an enacted law can stall at any stage after the first. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** The Pre-Legislative Consultation Policy of 2014 advises Union departments to publish draft legislation with an explanatory note and an ordinary minimum public comment window of about thirty days before introduction, and it is an executive policy rather than a statute whose comments are not binding, so publishing a draft is consultation compliance while incorporating feedback is consultation depth. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional value, commission recommendation, scheme catalogue, budget allocation, portal, disposal count or ranking cannot alone establish lawful authority, inclusive implementation, substantive remedy or attributable outcome; test capacity, federal competence, distribution, privacy, audit, appeal and current operative status.

Qualified conclusion: The aims are integrity-protective and general while the reach is authority-based and therefore specific, and conflating the two is precisely the error the scope half of the demand is designed to expose.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing authority -> institution -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; define and state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for inclusion, privacy, federal, indicator, grievance and current-status limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains implementation rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, federal, institutional, causal and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Examine the aims of the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 and the...", replace the weakest catalogue-style point with one named duty-holder, legal or executive basis, delivery bottleneck, process and outcome indicator, grievance route and evidence-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Examine how convergence and pre-legislative consultation can reduce the implementation gap in Indian public policy. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Consultation improves design realism at formulation and convergence removes clearance points at delivery, so the two correctives act at different stages and neither can substitute for the other or for functional devolution.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Convergence is the deliberate alignment of multiple schemes and departments toward a common local outcome, and its analytical value is that it adds no new scheme but removes clearance points and duplicate targeting between existing ones at the district and panchayat level, which is why it improves outcomes without a proportional increase in outlay and why it fails wherever functional devolution is absent.
- The Pre-Legislative Consultation Policy of 2014 advises Union departments to publish draft legislation with an explanatory note and an ordinary minimum public comment window of about thirty days before introduction, and it is an executive policy rather than a statute whose comments are not binding, so publishing a draft is consultation compliance while incorporating feedback is consultation depth.
- A regulatory impact assessment is a structured ex-ante assessment of a proposed regulation's costs, benefits and alternatives before it is finalised, and it remains unevenly institutionalised across Indian ministries and regulators, so it must be cited as an emerging good-governance practice rather than as a uniformly binding legal requirement.
- The Aspirational Districts Programme of NITI Aayog targets inter-district rather than inter-state divergence across 112 districts using 49 key performance indicators grouped into five themes - health and nutrition, education, agriculture and water resources, financial inclusion and skill development, and basic infrastructure - tracked on the Champions of Change dashboard, and it operates through the three named levers of convergence, collaboration including the Prabhari officer arrangement, and competition through delta ranking.

Qualified conclusion: Consultation improves design realism at formulation and convergence removes clearance points at delivery, so the two correctives act at different stages and neither can substitute for the other or for functional devolution.

Demand decoding: The directive **examine** requires a direct position on "Examine how convergence and pre-legislative consultation can reduce the implementation gap in...", every clause, exact authority and institutional boundary, an implementation chain, stakeholder/accountability map, Centre-state-local allocation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, safeguards and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Consultation improves design realism at formulation and convergence removes clearance points at delivery, so the two correctives act at different stages and neither can substitute for the other or for functional devolution.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Convergence is the deliberate alignment of multiple schemes and departments toward a common local outcome, and its analytical value is that it adds no new scheme but removes clearance points and duplicate targeting between existing ones at the district and panchayat level, which is why it improves outcomes without a proportional increase in outlay and why it fails wherever functional devolution is absent.
Analysis: Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The Pre-Legislative Consultation Policy of 2014 advises Union departments to publish draft legislation with an explanatory note and an ordinary minimum public comment window of about thirty days before introduction, and it is an executive policy rather than a statute whose comments are not binding, so publishing a draft is consultation compliance while incorporating feedback is consultation depth. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status,

Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

3. **Claim and named evidence:** A regulatory impact assessment is a structured ex-ante assessment of a proposed regulation's costs, benefits and alternatives before it is finalised, and it remains unevenly institutionalised across Indian ministries and regulators, so it must be cited as an emerging good-governance practice rather than as a uniformly binding legal requirement. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

4. **Claim and named evidence:** The Aspirational Districts Programme of NITI Aayog targets inter-district rather than inter-state divergence across 112 districts using 49 key performance indicators grouped into five themes - health and nutrition, education, agriculture and water resources, financial inclusion and skill development, and basic infrastructure - tracked on the Champions of Change dashboard, and it operates through the three named levers of convergence, collaboration including the Prabhari officer arrangement, and competition through delta ranking. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional value, commission recommendation, scheme catalogue, budget allocation, portal, disposal count or ranking cannot alone establish lawful authority, inclusive implementation, substantive remedy or attributable outcome; test capacity, federal competence, distribution, privacy, audit, appeal and current operative status.

Qualified conclusion: Consultation improves design realism at formulation and convergence removes clearance points at delivery, so the two correctives act at different stages and neither can substitute for the other or for functional devolution.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing authority -> institution -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; define and state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for inclusion, privacy, federal, indicator, grievance and current-status limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains implementation rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, federal, institutional, causal and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Examine how convergence and pre-legislative consultation can reduce the implementation gap in...", replace the weakest catalogue-style point with one named duty-holder, legal or executive basis, delivery bottleneck, process and outcome indicator, grievance route and evidence-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Assess the claim that contradictory sectoral policies rather than an absence of policy explain inadequate environmental protection in India. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: The coordination diagnosis holds wherever each ministry optimises its own objective function and the environmental cost appears in no departmental metric, but it fails where the conflict is a genuine value conflict that better process alone cannot resolve.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Environmental degradation is frequently produced not by an absence of policy but by mutually contradicting policies pursued by different ministries with separate mandates and no arbitration mechanism, because each sectoral ministry optimises its own objective function, no single actor is accountable for the aggregate outcome, and the environmental cost is an externality that appears in nobody's departmental performance metric - although some contradictions are genuine value conflicts between livelihood today and ecological stock tomorrow rather than coordination failures.
- PM GatiShakti is a National Master Plan approach for multi-modal infrastructure connectivity built on a shared geographic-information-system planning platform that layers infrastructure and utility data from multiple ministries, and its mechanism is the removal of sequencing failure and private-sector information risk through a common

map, but it coordinates information rather than authority, since land, utilities and many approvals remain with states and local bodies.

- A regulatory impact assessment is a structured ex-ante assessment of a proposed regulation's costs, benefits and alternatives before it is finalised, and it remains unevenly institutionalised across Indian ministries and regulators, so it must be cited as an emerging good-governance practice rather than as a uniformly binding legal requirement.
- Targeting concentrates scarce resources but requires identification machinery that itself excludes, while universalism avoids identification error at higher cost, and tightening verification reduces inclusion error where the ineligible are included while increasing exclusion error where the eligible are left out, so an entitlement affecting subsistence should fix the tolerable exclusion error first and add an offline or assisted fallback.

Qualified conclusion: The coordination diagnosis holds wherever each ministry optimises its own objective function and the environmental cost appears in no departmental metric, but it fails where the conflict is a genuine value conflict that better process alone cannot resolve.

Demand decoding: The directive **assess** requires a direct position on "Assess the claim that contradictory sectoral policies rather than an absence of policy...", every clause, exact authority and institutional boundary, an implementation chain, stakeholder/accountability map, Centre-state-local allocation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, safeguards and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The coordination diagnosis holds wherever each ministry optimises its own objective function and the environmental cost appears in no departmental metric, but it fails where the conflict is a genuine value conflict that better process alone cannot resolve.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Environmental degradation is frequently produced not by an absence of policy but by mutually contradicting policies pursued by different ministries with separate mandates and no arbitration mechanism, because each sectoral ministry optimises its own objective function, no single actor is accountable for the aggregate outcome, and the environmental cost is an externality that appears in nobody's departmental performance metric - although some contradictions are genuine value conflicts between livelihood today and ecological stock tomorrow rather than coordination failures. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** PM GatiShakti is a National Master Plan approach for multi-modal infrastructure connectivity built on a shared geographic-information-system planning platform that layers infrastructure and utility data from multiple ministries, and its mechanism is the removal of sequencing failure and private-sector information risk through a common map, but it coordinates information rather than authority, since land, utilities and many approvals remain with states and local bodies. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** A regulatory impact assessment is a structured ex-ante assessment of a proposed regulation's costs, benefits and alternatives before it is finalised, and it remains unevenly institutionalised across Indian ministries and regulators, so it must be cited as an emerging good-governance practice rather than as a uniformly binding legal requirement. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Targeting concentrates scarce resources but requires identification machinery that itself excludes, while universalism avoids identification error at higher cost, and tightening verification reduces inclusion error where the ineligible are included while increasing exclusion error where the eligible are left out, so an entitlement affecting subsistence should fix the tolerable exclusion error first and add an offline or assisted fallback. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation ->

process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional value, commission recommendation, scheme catalogue, budget allocation, portal, disposal count or ranking cannot alone establish lawful authority, inclusive implementation, substantive remedy or attributable outcome; test capacity, federal competence, distribution, privacy, audit, appeal and current operative status.

Qualified conclusion: The coordination diagnosis holds wherever each ministry optimises its own objective function and the environmental cost appears in no departmental metric, but it fails where the conflict is a genuine value conflict that better process alone cannot resolve.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing authority -> institution -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; define and state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for inclusion, privacy, federal, indicator, grievance and current-status limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains implementation rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, federal, institutional, causal and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Assess the claim that contradictory sectoral policies rather than an absence of policy...", replace the weakest catalogue-style point with one named duty-holder, legal or executive basis, delivery bottleneck, process and outcome indicator, grievance route and evidence-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Assess how far coordination instruments can substitute for authority in Indian infrastructure and service delivery. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: A shared information layer and a well-specified contract can reduce sequencing failure and information risk, but neither transfers authority over land, utilities or approvals, so coordination reforms raise the ceiling on delivery without removing the federal constraint beneath it.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- PM GatiShakti is a National Master Plan approach for multi-modal infrastructure connectivity built on a shared geographic-information-system planning platform that layers infrastructure and utility data from multiple ministries, and its mechanism is the removal of sequencing failure and private-sector information risk through a common map, but it coordinates information rather than authority, since land, utilities and many approvals remain with states and local bodies.
- A public-private partnership is a procurement and service-delivery choice rather than privatisation by definition, and its governance chain runs from public purpose and output standard through risk allocation to the actor best able to manage each risk, competitive procurement with disclosed criteria, performance-linked payment, independent monitoring and contract disclosure, renegotiation and exit rules, to affordability and continuity safeguards, with Viability Gap Funding supporting economically justified but commercially weak projects and the Hybrid Annuity Model illustrating deliberate risk-sharing.
- Delta ranking scores the pace of improvement rather than the absolute level so that the historically worst-off district is not permanently bottom and therefore permanently unmotivated, while the dashboard data is largely district-self-reported with validation by selected agencies and the district unit can mask intra-district divergence, which is why the Aspirational Blocks Programme covering 513 blocks exists as a separate and non-substitutable unit and why the programme is best read as an administrative-attention and convergence instrument rather than a financing instrument.
- The audited 2024-2025 Mains ledger routes the 2024 General Studies Paper-II demand on the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 to this Basic owner, while the audited 2018-2023 ledger routes three further demands - the 2018 General Studies Paper-I demand on aspirational districts, the 2018 General Studies Paper-II demand on policy contradictions and environmental degradation, and the 2022 General Studies Paper-II demand on Gati-Shakti coordination - to the Advanced owner, and the Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older Advanced pointer so that all four are answered from the core file.

Qualified conclusion: A shared information layer and a well-specified contract can reduce sequencing failure and information risk, but neither transfers authority over land, utilities or approvals, so coordination reforms raise the ceiling on delivery without removing the federal constraint beneath it.

Demand decoding: The directive **assess** requires a direct position on "Assess how far coordination instruments can substitute for authority in Indian infrastructure...", every clause, exact authority and institutional boundary, an implementation chain, stakeholder/accountability map, Centre-state-local allocation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, safeguards and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: A shared information layer and a well-specified contract can reduce sequencing failure and information risk, but neither transfers authority over land, utilities or approvals, so coordination reforms raise the ceiling on delivery without removing the federal constraint beneath it.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** PM GatiShakti is a National Master Plan approach for multi-modal infrastructure connectivity built on a shared geographic-information-system planning platform that layers infrastructure and utility data from multiple ministries, and its mechanism is the removal of sequencing failure and private-sector information risk through a common map, but it coordinates information rather than authority, since land, utilities and many approvals remain with states and local bodies. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** A public-private partnership is a procurement and service-delivery choice rather than privatisation by definition, and its governance chain runs from public purpose and output standard through risk allocation to the actor best able to manage each risk, competitive procurement with disclosed criteria, performance-linked payment, independent monitoring and contract disclosure, renegotiation and exit rules, to affordability and continuity safeguards, with Viability Gap Funding supporting economically justified but commercially weak projects and the Hybrid Annuity Model illustrating deliberate risk-sharing. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Delta ranking scores the pace of improvement rather than the absolute level so that the historically worst-off district is not permanently bottom and therefore permanently unmotivated, while the dashboard data is largely district-self-reported with validation by selected agencies and the district unit can mask intra-district divergence, which is why the Aspirational Blocks Programme covering 513 blocks exists as a separate and non-substitutable unit and why the programme is best read as an administrative-attention and convergence instrument rather than a financing instrument. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** The audited 2024-2025 Mains ledger routes the 2024 General Studies Paper-II demand on the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 to this Basic owner, while the audited 2018-2023 ledger routes three further demands - the 2018 General Studies Paper-I demand on aspirational districts, the 2018 General Studies Paper-II demand on policy contradictions and environmental degradation, and the 2022 General Studies Paper-II demand on Gati-Shakti coordination - to the Advanced owner, and the Basic owner records that core routing supersedes the older Advanced pointer so that all four are answered from the core file. **Analysis:** Connect authority -> institution and stakeholder incentives -> frontline implementation -> process/output/outcome effect -> accountability or grievance response. **Qualification:** State the jurisdiction, legal/executive status, Centre-state-local boundary, inclusion/privacy safeguard, causal limit, indicator weakness or residual trade-off.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional value, commission recommendation, scheme catalogue, budget allocation, portal, disposal count or ranking cannot alone establish lawful authority, inclusive implementation, substantive remedy or attributable outcome; test capacity, federal competence, distribution, privacy, audit, appeal and current operative

status.

Qualified conclusion: A shared information layer and a well-specified contract can reduce sequencing failure and information risk, but neither transfers authority over land, utilities or approvals, so coordination reforms raise the ceiling on delivery without removing the federal constraint beneath it.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing authority -> institution -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; define and state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for inclusion, privacy, federal, indicator, grievance and current-status limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains implementation rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, federal, institutional, causal and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Assess how far coordination instruments can substitute for authority in Indian infrastructure...", replace the weakest catalogue-style point with one named duty-holder, legal or executive basis, delivery bottleneck, process and outcome indicator, grievance route and evidence-status qualification.